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Distributed orchestration using delegate workspaces

Abstract

Systems and methods for distributed orchestration using delegate workspaces are described. In an illustrative, non-limiting embodiment, a remote orchestrator with respect to a workspace executed by a client Information Handling System (IHS) may include a processor and a memory coupled to the processor, the memory having program instructions stored thereon that, upon execution by the processor, cause the remote orchestrator to: communicate with a database of delegate workspaces, each delegate workspace instantiated by a respective one of a plurality of edge IHSs; and assign a management task with respect to a client IHS's workspace to a delegate workspace executed by a selected edge IHS, where the delegate workspace is selected, at least in part, based upon information stored in the database.

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Background/Summary

FIELD

(1) This disclosure relates generally to Information Handling Systems (IHSs), and, more specifically, to systems and methods for distributed orchestration using delegate workspaces.

BACKGROUND

(2) As the value and use of information continues to increase, individuals and businesses seek additional ways to process and store it. One option available to users is an Information Handling System (IHS). An IHS generally processes, compiles, stores, and/or communicates information or data for business, personal, or other purposes thereby allowing users to take advantage of the value of the information. Because technology and information handling needs and requirements vary between different users or applications, IHSs may also vary regarding what information is handled, how the information is handled, how much information is processed, stored, or communicated, and how quickly and efficiently the information may be processed, stored, or communicated. Variations in IHSs allow for IHSs to be general or configured for a specific user or specific use such as financial transaction processing, airline reservations, enterprise data storage, or global communications. In addition, IHSs may include a variety of hardware and software components that may be configured to process, store, and communicate information and may include one or more computer systems, data storage systems, and networking systems.

(3) Once an IHS has been delivered and deployed, malicious actors may seek to gain access to the IHS. Upon gaining such access to the IHS, a malicious actor may attempt to download protected data from the IHS, such as downloading trade secrets, personal information and financial information from the IHS. A malicious actor may also attempt to upload data to a compromised IHS, such as uploading malicious instructions that provide the malicious actor with at least some control of the IHS. Malicious actors may attempt to gain access to an IHS via a wide variety of

entry points. The set of possible entry points for gaining access to an IHS or disabling an IHS may be referred to as the attack surface of the IHS.

(4) Organizations may own and/or manage large numbers of IHSs. For instance, an employer may provide laptop computers to employees and may also operate various other types of IHSs, such as rack-mounted servers and networking equipment, to support operation of the laptops. The provided laptops may be operated in a variety of scenarios, both for performing job functions and for personal use. In another example, educational institutions may support various types of IHSs, such as tablets and laptops, that are issued to students and employees. Medical institutions may also support a variety of IHSs that may be used by patients, visitors and/or staff. In all such instances, the users and IHSs that are being supported is continually in flux.

(5) Many IHSs, such as laptops and tablets, are portable and are commonly used in different locations, even if different locations within a single building or residence. More generally, portable IHSs may be regularly used in different public and private locations. Based on such changes in location, an IHS may be coupled to different external devices, such as a laptop being docked at different workstations. In some instances, the external devices that may be occasionally connected to an IHS may include both public and private devices, such as use of an IHS while coupled to a home office workstation and use of the IHS at an airport, hotel, or corporate shared-use workstation. Organizations seeking to provide IHS users with access protected data must be prepared to do so in a wide variety of operational scenarios.

SUMMARY

(6) Systems and methods for distributed orchestration using delegate workspaces are described. In an illustrative, non-limiting embodiment, a remote orchestrator with respect to a workspace executed by a client Information Handling System (IHS) may include a processor and a memory coupled to the processor, the memory having program instructions stored thereon that, upon execution by the processor, cause the remote orchestrator to: communicate with a database of delegate workspaces, each delegate workspace instantiated by a respective one of a plurality of edge IHSs; and assign a management task with respect to a client IHS's workspace to a delegate workspace executed by a selected edge IHS, where the delegate workspace is selected, at least in part, based upon information stored in the database.

(7) In some implementations, the remote orchestrator may be operated by an entity selected from the group consisting of: an Information Technology Decision Maker (ITDM), an Original Equipment Manufacturer (OEM), a workspace management software developer, and a third-party. The database of delegate workspaces may be created based, at least in part, upon enrollment processes performed, at least in part, by local agents executed by the plurality of edge IHSs.

(8) The program instructions, upon execution, may cause the remote orchestrator to communicate with another database of edge IHSs, and to select an edge IHS associated with the selected delegate workspace. The other database may be configured to maintain an indication of a mesh network topology for the edge IHSs. The edge IHS may belong to a different domain than the remote orchestrator, and the remote orchestrator may be configured to provide credentials to the edge IHS via another remote orchestrator for communicating with the client IHS.

(9) The program instructions, upon execution, may cause the remote orchestrator to communicate with another database of management tasks, and to select the management task. The management task may include at least one of: a Basic Input/Output System (BIOS) command, a telemetry collection command, a workspace termination command, a workspace instantiation command, a policy update, or a workspace definition change.

(10) The program instructions, upon execution, may cause the remote orchestrator to select the delegate workspace, at least in part, based upon a proximity between the client IHS and the selected edge IHS. Additionally, or alternatively, the program instructions, upon execution, may further cause the remote orchestrator to select the delegate workspace, at least in part, based upon a security risk score associated with the delegate workspace. Additionally, or alternatively, the

program instructions, upon execution, may cause the remote orchestrator to identify additional or fewer management tasks to be assigned to the delegate workspace, at least in part, based upon a change to the security risk score. Additionally, or alternatively, the program instructions, upon execution, further cause the remote orchestrator to re-assign the management task to another delegate workspace executed by another edge IHS, at least in part, based upon a change to the security risk score of the selected delegate workspace.

(11) The program instructions, upon execution, may cause the remote orchestrator to select the delegate workspace, at least in part, based upon a productivity score associated with the delegate workspace. Additionally, or alternatively, the program instructions, upon execution, may further cause the remote orchestrator to identify additional or fewer management tasks to be assigned to the delegate workspace, at least in part, based upon a change to the productivity score.

Additionally, or alternatively, the program instructions, upon execution, may cause the remote orchestrator to re-assign the management task to another delegate workspace executed by another edge IHS, at least in part, based upon a change to the productivity score of the selected delegate workspace.

(12) The remote orchestrator may be configured to transmit a file to the selected edge IHS that enables instantiation of the delegate workspace based upon a workspace definition. The program instructions, upon execution, may cause the remote orchestrator to: calculate a security target and a productivity target based upon context information; and create the workspace definition based upon the security target and the productivity target.

(13) For example, the context information may include at least one of: an identification of a location of the selected edge IHS, an identification of a user of the selected edge IHS, an identification of a network of the selected edge IHS, or an identification of hardware of the selected edge IHS.

(14) In an illustrative, non-limiting embodiment, a memory device may have program instructions stored thereon that, upon execution by a processor of an edge IHS, causes the edge IHS to: instantiate a delegate workspace; and process a management command received from a remote orchestrator, wherein the management command targets a workspace executed by a client IHS accessible to the edge IHS, and wherein the edge IHS is selected by the remote orchestrator, at least in part, based upon at least one of: a security risk score of the workspace, a productivity score of the workspace, a security risk score of the delegate workspace, or a productivity score of the delegate workspace.

(15) In yet another illustrative, non-limiting embodiment, a method may include: receiving, at a client IHS, a management command relayed by a delegate workspace instantiated by an edge IHS, wherein the management command is originated by a cloud orchestrator, and wherein the cloud orchestrator is configured to select the edge IHS among a plurality of edge IHS based, at least in part, upon at least one of: a security risk score of the workspace, a productivity score of the workspace, a security risk score of the delegate workspace, or a productivity score of the delegate workspace; and executing, by the client IHS, the management command.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The present invention(s) is/are illustrated by way of example and is/are not limited by the accompanying figures, in which like references indicate similar elements. Elements in the figures are illustrated for simplicity and clarity and have not necessarily been drawn to scale.

(2) FIG. 1 is a diagram depicting illustrative components of an Information Handling System (IHS) configured to support workspaces operating on the IHS, according to various embodiments.

(3) FIGS. 2A and 2B are diagrams depicting a method for orchestrating the deployment and

operation of workspaces on an IHS, according to various embodiments.

(4) FIGS. 3A and 3B are a diagram depicting an example of a system configured for deploying and operating workspaces on an IHS, according to various embodiments.

(5) FIG. 4 is a diagram illustrating an example of a system for managing credentials usable in the orchestration of workspaces by multiple remote orchestrators, according to various embodiments.

(6) FIGS. 5-7 are diagrams illustrating examples of methods for managing credentials usable in the remote orchestration of workspaces, according to various embodiments.

(7) FIG. 8 is a diagram illustrating an example of a system for distributed orchestration of workspaces using delegate workspaces, according to various embodiments.

(8) FIGS. 9A-C are diagrams illustrating examples of methods 900A-C for distributed orchestration of workspaces using delegate workspaces, according to various embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(9) For purposes of this disclosure, an IHS may include any instrumentality or aggregate of instrumentalities operable to compute, calculate, determine, classify, process, transmit, receive, retrieve, originate, switch, store, display, communicate, manifest, detect, record, reproduce, handle, or utilize any form of information, intelligence, or data for business, scientific, control, or other purposes. For example, an IHS may be a personal computer (e.g., desktop or laptop), tablet computer, mobile device (e.g., Personal Digital Assistant (PDA) or smart phone), server (e.g., blade server or rack server), a network storage device, or any other suitable device and may vary in size, shape, performance, functionality, and price. An example of an IHS is described in more detail below. FIG. 1 shows various internal components of an IHS configured to implement certain of the described embodiments. It should be appreciated that although certain embodiments described herein may be discussed in the context of a personal computing device, such as laptop computers, other embodiments may utilize various other types of IHSs, such as rack-mounted servers.

(10) FIG. 1 is a diagram depicting illustrative components of an Information Handling System (IHS) 100 configured, according to various embodiments, to support workspaces operating on the IHS. In some embodiments, IHS 100 may be employed to instantiate, manage, and/or terminate a workspace, such as a secure environment that may provide the user of IHS 100 with access to enterprise data while isolating the enterprise data from an Operating System (OS) and/or other applications executed by IHS 100. A workspace may operate using a variety of different configurations of the hardware and software resources of the IHS 100, where the resources that are used may be selected based on the security and risk context of a request to access protected data. As described in additional detail below, a primary workspace and one or more subordinate workspaces may operate on an IHS 100, such that a variety of workspace topologies may be supported using the available computing resources of the IHS 100, including computing resources of external devices coupled to the IHS. Based on the current risk and security context in which an IHS 100 is operating, embodiments may switch between use of different workspace topologies that are supported by an IHS.

(11) As shown in FIG. 1, IHS 100 includes one or more processor(s) 101, such as a Central Processing Unit (CPU), operable to execute code retrieved from system memory 105. Although IHS 100 is illustrated with a single processor, other embodiments may include two or more processors, that may each be configured identically, or to provide specialized processing functions. Processor(s) 101 may include any processor capable of executing program instructions, such as an INTEL PENTIUM series processor or any general-purpose or embedded processors implementing any of a variety of Instruction Set Architectures (ISAs), such as the x86, POWERPC®, ARM®, SPARC®, or MIPS® ISAs. In the embodiment of FIG. 1, processor(s) 101 includes an integrated memory controller 118 that may be implemented directly within the circuitry of processor(s) 101, or memory controller 118 may be a separate integrated circuit that is located on the same die as processor(s) 101. Memory controller 118 may be configured to manage the transfer of data to and from system memory 105 of IHS 100 via high-speed memory interface 104.

(12) System memory **105** that is coupled to processor(s) **101** via memory bus **104** provides processor(s) **101** with a high-speed memory that may be used in the execution of computer program instructions by processor(s) **101**. Accordingly, system memory **105** may include memory components, such as static RAM (SRAM), dynamic RAM (DRAM), NAND Flash memory, suitable for supporting high-speed memory operations by processor(s) **101**. In some embodiments, system memory **105** may combine both persistent, non-volatile memory and volatile memory.

(13) In certain embodiments, system memory **105** includes secure storage **120** that may be a segregated and protected portion of the system memory designated for storage of information, such as access policies, component signatures, encryption keys, and other cryptographic information, for use in hosting a secure workspace on IHS **100**. In such embodiments, a signature may be calculated based on the contents of secure storage **120** and stored as a reference signature. The integrity of the data stored in secure storage **120** may then be validated at a later time by recalculating this signature of the contents of the secure storage and comparing the recalculated signature against the reference signature.

(14) IHS **100** utilizes chipset **103** that may include one or more integrated circuits that are coupled to processor(s) **101**. In the embodiment of FIG. 1, processor(s) **101** is depicted as a component of chipset **103**. In other embodiments, all of chipset **103**, or portions of chipset **103** may be implemented directly within the integrated circuitry of processor(s) **101**. Chipset **103** provides processor(s) **101** with access to a variety of resources accessible via bus **102**. In IHS **100**, bus **102** is illustrated as a single element. However, other implementations may utilize any number of buses to provide the illustrated pathways served by bus **102**.

(15) As illustrated, a variety of resources may be coupled to processor(s) **101** of IHS **100** through chipset **103**. For instance, chipset **103** may be coupled to network interface **109**, such as provided by a Network Interface Controller (NIC) that is coupled to IHS **100** and allows IHS **100** to communicate via a network, such as the Internet or a LAN. Network interface device **109** may provide IHS **100** with wired and/or wireless network connections via a variety of network technologies, such as wireless cellular or mobile networks (CDMA, TDMA, LTE etc.), WIFI and BLUETOOTH. As described in additional detail below, in certain embodiments, network interface **109** may support connections between a trusted IHS component, such as trusted controller **115**, and a remote orchestration service. In such embodiments, a connection supported by network interface **109** between the remote orchestration service and the trusted component may be considered an out-of-band (OOB) connection that is isolated from the OS of the IHS. In some embodiments, an OOB connection supported by network interface **109** may support a variety of remote management operations by trusted controller **115**, including providing remote management of IHS **100** and/or of hardware components installed in IHS **100**. As described in additional detail below, embodiments of IHS **100** may utilize OOB connections to interface with multiple remote orchestration services that may each provide different types of support for workspaces operating on IHS **100**.

(16) Chipset **102** of IHS **100** may also provide access to one or more display device(s) **108** via graphics processor **107**. In certain embodiments, graphics processor **107** may be comprised within one or more video or graphics cards or an embedded controller installed as components of IHS **100**. Graphics processor **107** may generate display information and provide the generated information to one or more display device(s) **108** coupled to IHS **100**, where display device(s) **108** may include integrated display devices and/or external display devices coupled to IHS, such as via an I/O port **116**, where display device(s) **108** may include integrated display devices and/or external display devices coupled to IHS. In certain embodiments, graphics processor **107** may be integrated within processor **101**. The one or more display devices **108** coupled to IHS **100** may utilize LCD, LED, OLED, or other thin film display technologies. Each display device **108** may be capable of touch input such as via a touch controller that may be an embedded component of display device **108**, graphics processor **107**, or a separate component of IHS **100** accessed via bus **102**. In some

embodiments, a display device **108** coupled to IHS may include discrete logic and memory resources that may be used in the operation of a workspace. As described in additional detail below, in embodiments, a subordinate workspace may operate using the resources of display device **108** and may operate based on a workspace definition provided by a primary workspace operating on core resources of IHS **100**, such as CPU **101** and system memory **105**. In some scenarios, an external display device **108** coupled to IHS **100** may be a public or shared-use display monitor, such as provided to the user of IHS **100** via a shared or public workstation.

(17) In certain embodiments, chipset **103** may utilize one or more I/O controllers **110** to access hardware components such as user input devices **111** and sensors **112**. For instance, I/O controller **110** may provide access to user-input devices **111** such as a keyboard, mouse, touchpad, touchscreen and/or other peripheral input devices. User input devices **111** may interface with I/O controller **110** through wired or wireless connections. In some embodiments, any or all of the user-input devices **111** coupled to IHS may be discrete devices with their own logic and memory resources that may be used in the operation of a workspace. As described in additional detail below, a subordinate workspace may operate using the resources of such user-input devices **111** and may operate based on a workspace definition provided by a primary workspace operating on core resources of IHS **100**. In some scenarios, user-input devices **111** coupled to IHS **100** may be a public or shared-use devices, such as a keyboard and mouse of a shared or public workstation.

(18) Sensors **112** accessed via I/O controllers **110** may provide access to data describing environmental and operating conditions of IHS **100** (e.g., accelerometers, gyroscopes, hinge sensors, rotation sensors, hall effect sensors, temperature sensors, voltage sensors, sensors, IR sensors, photosensors, proximity sensors, distance sensors, magnetic sensors, microphones, ultrasonic sensors, etc.). In some embodiments, any or all of the sensors **112** coupled to IHS may be discrete devices with their own logic and memory resources that may be used in the operation of a workspace. A subordinate workspace may operate using the resources of such sensors **112** and may operate based on a workspace definition provided by a primary workspace operating on core resources of IHS **100**.

(19) In some cases, chipset **103** may include a sensor hub capable of utilizing information collected by sensors **112** in determining the relative orientation and movement of IHS **100**. For instance, the sensor hub may utilize inertial movement sensors, that may include accelerometer, gyroscope, and magnetometer sensors, and can determine the orientation and movement of IHS **100** (e.g., IHS **100** is motionless on a relatively flat surface, IHS **100** is being moved irregularly and is likely in transport, the hinge of IHS **100** is oriented in a vertical direction thus indicating the IHS **100** is being used in a book mode). In certain embodiments, the sensor hub may also include capabilities for determining a location and movement of IHS **100** based on triangulation of network signal and based on network information provided by the OS or network interface **109**. In some embodiments, the sensor hub may support additional sensors, such as optical, infrared and sonar sensors, that may provide support for xR (virtual, augmented, and/or mixed reality) sessions hosted by the IHS **100** and may be used by the sensor hub provide an indication of a user's presence near IHS **100**, such as whether a user is present, absent, inattentive and/or facing integrated display **108**.

(20) In cases where the end-user is present before IHS **100**, the sensor hub may further determine a distance between the end-user and the IHS, where this determination may be made continuously, at periodic intervals, or upon request. The detected or calculated distances may be used by processor **101** to classify the user as being in the IHS's near-field (user's position < threshold distance A), mid-field (threshold distance A < user's position < threshold distance B, where B > A), or far-field (user's position > threshold distance C, where C > B). As described in additional detail below, the failure to detect an authenticated user of IHS **100** within a proximity of IHS **100** may result in a change in the security context of IHS **100**, thus triggering a re-evaluation of the security risk of workspaces operating on IHS **100**. Similar re-evaluation may be triggered based on the detection of additional individuals in proximity to IHS **100**.

(21) In embodiments where IHS **100** may support multiple physical configurations, such as a convertible laptop, N-in-1 device, or the like, the sensor hub may utilize one or more mode sensors **112** that collect readings that may be used in determining the posture in which IHS **100** is physically configured. In certain embodiments, such posture determinations may be additionally made using the movement and orientation information provided by sensors **112**. In laptop and convertible laptop embodiments, for example, processor **101** or trusted controller **115** may utilize a lid position sensor **112** to determine the relative angle between the two panels of the laptop to determine the mode in which IHS **100** is physically configured. In such embodiments, the lid position sensor may measure the angle of rotation of the hinge that connects the base panel and lid panel of IHS **100**. In some embodiments, processor **101** or trusted controller **115** may provide collected lid position information, such as the hinge angle, to the sensor hub for use in determining the posture in which IHS **100** is configured. In some embodiments, the sensor hub may interface directly with the lid position sensor in determining hinge angle information.

(22) The sensor hub may determine the posture of IHS **100** based, at least in part, on the angle of rotation of the hinge of IHS **100** from a closed position. Starting from a closed position, a first range of hinge angles may indicate a laptop posture, a second range of hinge angles may indicate a landscape posture, and a third range of hinge angles may indicate a tablet posture of the IHS **100**. The sensor hub may additionally utilize orientation and movement information collected from inertial movement sensors **112** to further determine the posture in which IHS **100** is physically configured. For instance, if the sensor hub determines that IHS **100** is configured with a hinge angle of a laptop configuration, but IHS **100** is oriented on its side with the hinge in a vertical orientation, the IHS may be determined to be in a book mode. In another example where the IHS **100** is determined to be tilted such that the hinge is oriented between horizontal and vertical, the user's face is detected to be facing the integrated display, and IHS **100** is experiencing irregular, slight movements, the sensor hub may determine that IHS **100** is being used in a book posture while the user is in transit. In another example, the sensor hub may determine that IHS **100** is opened to a 180-degree hinge angle and lies on a flat surface, thus indicating that IHS **100** it is being used in a landscape posture. The sensor hub may similarly determine that IHS **100** is in a tent configuration in response to detecting a hinge angle within a defined range, such as between 300 and 345 degrees, and detecting an orientation of IHS **100** where the hinge is aligned horizontally and is higher than both of the display panels of IHS **100**.

(23) Other components of IHS **100** may include one or more I/O ports **116** for communicating with peripheral external devices as well as various input and output devices. For instance, I/O **116** ports may include HDMI (High-Definition Multimedia Interface) ports for use in connecting external display devices to IHS **100** and USB (Universal Serial Bus) ports, by which a variety of external devices may be coupled to IHS **100**. In some embodiments, external devices coupled to IHS **100** via an I/O port **116** may include storage devices that support transfer of data to and from system memory **105** and/or storage devices **119** of IHS **100**. As described in additional detail below, the coupling of storage devices via an I/O port **116** may result in a change in the security profile of IHS **100**, thus triggering a re-evaluation of the security risk of workspaces operating on IHS **100**. In some embodiments, peripherals coupled to IHS **100** via I/O ports **116** may be discrete devices with their own logic and memory resources that may be used in the operation of a workspace. As described in additional detail below, a subordinate workspace may operate using the resources of such external peripherals and may operate based on a workspace definition provided by a primary workspace operating on core resources of IHS **100**. In some scenarios, external peripherals coupled to IHS **100** may be a public or shared-use devices, such as a projector utilized within a conference room.

(24) Chipset **103** also provides processor(s) **101** with access to one or more storage devices **119**. In various embodiments, storage device(s) **119** may be integral to IHS **100**, or may be external to IHS **100**. In certain embodiments, storage device(s) **119** may be accessed via a storage controller that

may be an integrated component of the storage device. Storage device(s) **119** may be implemented using any memory technology allowing IHS **100** to store and retrieve data. For instance, storage device(s) **119** may be a magnetic hard disk storage drive or a solid-state storage drive. In some embodiments, storage device(s) **119** may be a system of storage devices, such as a cloud drive accessible via network interface **109**. In some embodiments, storage devices **119** coupled to IHS **100** may be discrete devices with their own logic and memory resources that may be used in the operation of a workspace. A subordinate workspace may operate using the resources of such storage devices **119** and may operate based on a workspace definition provided by a primary workspace operating on core resources of IHS **100**.

(25) As illustrated, IHS **100** also includes BIOS (Basic Input/Output System) **117** that may be stored in a non-volatile memory accessible by chipset **103** via bus **102**. Upon powering or restarting IHS **100**, processor(s) **101** may utilize BIOS **117** instructions to initialize and test hardware components coupled to IHS **100**. BIOS **117** instructions may also load an OS for use by IHS **100**. BIOS **117** provides an abstraction layer that allows the OS to interface with the hardware components of IHS **100**. The Unified Extensible Firmware Interface (UEFI) was designed as a successor to BIOS. As a result, many modern IHSs utilize UEFI in addition to or instead of a BIOS. As used herein, BIOS is intended to also encompass UEFI.

(26) In certain embodiments, a trusted controller **115** is coupled to IHS **100** and may support various functions for management of IHS **100**. For example, trusted controller **115** may be an embedded controller (EC) that is installed as a component of the motherboard of IHS **100**. In various embodiments, trusted controller **115** may perform various operations in support of the delivery and deployment of a workspace to IHS **100**. In certain embodiments, trusted controller **115** may interoperate with a remote orchestration service via an out-of-band communications pathway that is isolated from the OS that runs on IHS **100**. Network interface **109** may support such out-of-band communications between trusted controller **115** and a remote orchestration service. In some embodiments, such out-of-band communications may be utilized by a remote orchestration service in communicating with the trusted controller **115** in selecting the resources of the IHS that are used as the underlying computing architecture that is used to host a workspace on the IHS **100**.

(27) Trusted controller **115** may receive cryptographic information required for secure delivery and deployment of a workspace to IHS **100**. In such embodiments, the cryptographic information may be stored to secured storage **121** maintained by trusted controller **115**. Additionally, or alternatively, trusted controller **115** may support execution of a trusted operating environment that may support cryptographic operations used to deploy a workspace on IHS **100**. Additionally, or alternatively, trusted controller **115** may support deployment of a workspace within the OS of IHS **100** via an out-of-band communications channel that is isolated from the OS and allows the workspace to communicate with a trusted agent process of the OS.

(28) Trusted controller **115** may also provide support for certain cryptographic processing used to support secure deployment and operation of workspaces on IHS **100**. In some embodiments, such cryptographic processing may be provided via a secure logical environment that operates using computational and memory resources of trusted controller **115**, where the environment operates in isolation from the software and other hardware components of IHS **100**. In some embodiments, trusted controller **115** may rely on cryptographic processing provided by dedicated cryptographic hardware supported by the IHS, such as a TPM (Trusted Platform Module) microcontroller. In some embodiments, the memory resources of trusted controller **115** include a secured storage **121** that may be utilized to store cryptographic information for use in authorization of workspaces.

(29) In certain embodiments, cryptographic capabilities of trusted controller **115** may be used to calculate signatures that uniquely identify individual components of IHS **100**. In such scenarios, trusted controller **115** may calculate a hash value based on instructions used to configure a hardware component coupled to IHS **100** and/or based on a set of instructions used to operate a software program. For instance, trusted controller **115** may calculate a hash value based on

firmware, settings and/or other instructions that are used in the operation of a hardware component coupled to the IHS **100**, such as by a network controller, storage drive, storage controller, FPGA, or hardware accelerator. In some instances, reference signatures for individual components of an IHS **100** may be calculated as part of a trusted manufacturing and factory provisioning process of the IHS and may be stored for use as reference signatures within a secure storage **121** of the trusted controller **115**.

(30) Once the IHS **100** has been delivered and deployed, trusted controller **115** may be configured to calculate hash values based on firmware and other instructions that are loaded for use by individual hardware components of the IHS. The hash value recalculated for the component may then be compared against the reference signature in order to determine if any modifications have been made to the instructions to be used to operate the component, thus indicating the component has been compromised. In this manner, trusted controller **115** may be used to validate the integrity of hardware and software components installed on IHS **100**. In certain embodiments, remote orchestration service **206** may verify the integrity of trusted controller **115** in the same manner, by calculating a signature based on instructions being utilized to operate trusted controller **115** and comparing it to a reference signature calculated during a trusted process for manufacture of IHS **100**. In various embodiments, one or more of these operations supported by trusted controller **115** may be implemented using BIOS **117**.

(31) In some embodiments, firmware instructions utilized by trusted controller **115** may also implement procedures for the management of power that is available for operating IHS **100**. For instance, trusted controller **115** may interface with a power adapter in managing the output levels of the power adapter that may be drawn for use by IHS **100**. In some embodiments, trusted controller may determine the power status of IHS **100**, such as whether IHS **100** is operating strictly from battery power or is plugged into an AC power source and may specify restrictions on power use based on the power status of the IHS. Trusted controller **115** may be used to operate a secure execution environment that may include operations for managing various core functions of IHS **100** based on power availability, such as power management and management of certain operating modes of IHS **100** (e.g., turbo modes, maximum operating clock frequencies of certain components, etc.). Accordingly, IHS **100** may support the use of various power modes. In some embodiments, the power modes of IHS **100** may be implemented through operations of trusted controller **115** and/or the OS of IHS **100**. In various embodiments, IHS **100** may support various reduced power modes to reduce power consumption and/or conserve battery power when IHS **100** is not actively in use, and/or to control a level of performance available to the user by increasing or decreasing a maximum operating clock frequency of a component of IHS **100** (e.g., processor(s) **101**).

(32) In managing operating modes of IHS **100**, trusted controller **115** may implement operations for detecting certain changes to the physical configuration of IHS **100** and managing the modes corresponding to different physical configurations of IHS **100**. For instance, where IHS **100** is a laptop computer or a convertible laptop computer, trusted controller **115** may receive inputs from a lid position sensor **112** that may detect whether the two sides of the laptop have been latched together to a closed position. In response to lid position sensor **112** detecting latching of the lid of IHS **100**, trusted controller **115** may initiate operations for shutting down IHS **100** or placing IHS **100** in a low-power mode.

(33) As described in additional detail below, an IHS **100** may support the operation of one or more workspaces, each operating using resources of IHS **100** that are specified within a respective workspace definition, where an individual workspace provides operation of software programs and access to protected data in varying degrees of isolation from the operating system of the IHS and from other workspaces. Also as described in additional detail below, an individual workspace may be hosted by an IHS **100** using various combinations of the described software and hardware resources of the IHS.

(34) For instance, a workspace may be configured to operate as a type of virtual machine that runs in isolation from the operating system of the IHS **100**, but that relies on certain shared software libraries and other resource of the IHS **100**. In another instance, a workspace may operate as a different type of virtual machine that not only runs in isolation from the operating system of the IHS **100**, but also does not share any libraries and operates using a segregated portion of memory **105** of the IHS. In another instance, a workspace may operate as a container application that runs within the operating system of the IHS **100**, but that provides a segregated computing environment in which applications and data that are accessed via the container are not otherwise accessible by other programs or containers hosted by the operating system. In another instance, a workspace may operate within the operating system of an IHS **100** as a web-browser application that runs using libraries and other resources utilized by the web browser. In another instance, a workspace may be configured to operate such that a graphical interface for the workspace is displayed in a display device **108** of the IHS **100**, but the workspace operates in full or in part in a cloud resource, thus isolating certain aspects of the workspace entirely from the IHS **100**. In each of these scenarios, a workspace may operate using a primary workspace that operates on core resources of an IHS and using one or more subordinate workspaces that operate on external devices that are coupled to an IHS **100**.

(35) Each of these exemplary computing architectures that utilize resources of IHS **100**, to support workspaces present different attack surfaces that may be exploited by malicious actors. As described in additional detail below, the computing architecture that is selected for use by a workspace may be selected based in part on a security context that may account for the security posture of the IHS **100**, the user of the IHS **100**, the use of subordinate workspaces, the environment in which IHS **100** is being operated and/or the information that is being accessed via the workspace. As such, the attack surface presented by the computing architecture of a workspace, and any subordinate workspaces, may be selected to be commensurate with the security context in which the workspace will operate.

(36) In some embodiments, an IHS **100** may not include all of the components shown in FIG. **1**. In other embodiments, an IHS **100** may include other components in addition to those that are shown in FIG. **1**. Furthermore, some components that are represented as separate components in FIG. **1** may instead be integrated with other components. For example, in certain embodiments, all or a portion of the operations executed by the illustrated components may instead be provided by components integrated into processor(s) **101** as a System-on-Chip.

(37) In some embodiments, the construction of a workspace for a particular purpose and for use in a particular context may be orchestrated remotely from IHS **100** by workspace orchestration services **206**, such as described with regard to FIGS. **2A** and **2B**. In some embodiments, portions of the workspace orchestration, including the creation and delegation of tasks to subordinate workspaces, may be performed locally on IHS **100**. IHS **100** may be configured with program instructions that, upon execution, cause IHS **100** to perform one or more of the various operations disclosed herein. In some embodiments, IHS **100** may be an element of a larger enterprise system that may include any number of similarly configured IHSs in network communications with each other.

(38) FIGS. **2A** and **2B** are diagrams depicting a method, according to various embodiments, for orchestrating the deployment and operation of workspaces on an IHS **100**. For sake of illustration, the method has been split into three phases: workspace initialization phase **200A**, workspace orchestration phase **200B**, and workspace termination phase **200C**.

(39) During initialization phase **200A**, user **201** (e.g., an enterprise user) operates an IHS **100** (e.g., a desktop, a laptop, a tablet, a smart phone, etc.), such as described with regard to FIG. **1**, within physical environment **202** (e.g., any type of environment and its associated context, including physical location, geographic location, location within a particular facility or building, detected wireless networks, time of day, proximity of the user to IHS **100**, other individuals in the vicinity of

IHS 100, etc.).

(40) In some embodiments, initialization phase **200B** may begin with user **201** selecting workspace options that are supported by launch point **203** that may be, for example, a corporate launch point provided by an employer of user **201**, a launch point provided by the manufacturer of IHS **100**, a launch point provided in support of a software application operating on IHS **100**, or a launch point provided as a service to user **201** by a third-party. In some implementations, user **201** may operate IHS **100** to access launch point **203** provided, for example, in the form of a web portal, a portal application running in the OS of IHS **100**, a special-purpose portal workspace operating on IHS **100**, or the like.

(41) In various implementations, launch point **203** may include Graphical User Interface (GUI) elements representing different software applications, data sources and/or other resources that the user may desire to execute and/or manipulate within a workspace. In various embodiments, launch point may provide a graphical, textual and/or audio interface by which data or other resources may be requested for use within a workspace by user **201**. In this manner, user **201** may be provided with launch point **203** selections that provide access to one or more software applications and an aggregation of user's data sources that are available across one or more datastores (e.g., local storage, cloud storage, etc.).

(42) As described in additional detail below, workspaces for providing user **201** with access to requested data or other resources may operate using a local management agent **332** that operates on IHS **100** and is configured to interoperate with a workspace orchestration service that may include one or more remote workspace orchestrators **206A-N**. In various embodiments, launch point **203** may be provided in the form of a portal (e.g., a webpage, OS application or special purpose workspace) that allows user **201** to request access to managed resources.

(43) In various embodiments, launch point **203** may be hosted by a remote workspace orchestrator **206A-N**, local management agent **332** operating on IHS **100**, or any suitable combination thereof. Examples of launch point **203** technologies may include WORKSPACE ONE INTELLIGENT HUB from WMWARE, INC., and DELL HYBRID CLIENT from DELL TECHNOLOGIES INC., among others.

(44) In other embodiments, initialization phase **200A** may begin when user **201** chooses to launch an application or access a data source managed by a workspace orchestration service that may be implemented using one or more workspace orchestrators **206A-N**. In response to an access request issued by user **201** (e.g., the user “clicks” on an icon of launch point **203**), local management agent **332** of IHS **100** collects initial security and productivity context information at **204**.

(45) For example, security context information may include attributes indicating a security risk associated with: the data and/or application being requested, a level of risk presented by the user **201**, the hardware utilized by IHS **100**, the logical environment of IHS **100** in which a workspace will be deployed to provide access to the requested data and/or application, characteristics of external devices **100A-H** that are coupled to IHS **100**, and the physical environment **202** in which IHS **100** is currently located.

(46) Accordingly, in this disclosure, the term “security context” generally refers to data or other information related to a security posture in which a workspace will be deployed and utilized, where the security posture may be based on the user, IHS **100**, security characteristics of external devices **100A-H** coupled to IHS **100**, data to be accessed via the workspace, and/or environment **202**. A security context may be quantified as a security risk score in support of evaluations of the level or risk associated with providing user **201** access to requested data and/or application while using IHS **100** in the particular context. A “security risk score” generally refers to a numerical value usable to score, quantify, or measure various security characteristics of the security context associated with a request. A risk score may be an aggregate score associated with the overall security risk context, whereas a “risk metric” may be a measurement of risk for a sub-category of some part of the security context.

(47) For example, security metrics that may be used in the calculation of a security risk score for a particular security context may include, but are not limited to: a classification of the requested data source and/or application, authentication factors used to identify user **201**, the location of IHS **100**, a role or other group classifications associated with user **201**, validation of networks in use by IHS **100**, type of network in use by IHS **100**, network firewall configurations in use by IHS **100**, indicators of attack (IoA), indicators of compromise (IoC) regarding IHS **100** or a resource being requested by user **201**, patch levels associated with the OS and other applications in use on IHS **100**, availability of encryption, type of available encryption, access to secured storage, use of attestable hardware by IHS **100**, supported degree of workspace isolation by IHS **100**, external devices **100A-H** that are coupled to IHS **100**, etc.

(48) The term “productivity context” generally refers to user productivity associated with a workspace, user, IHS, and/or environment. A “productivity score” generally refers to an index usable to score, quantify, or measure various productivity characteristics of a productivity context. Examples of productivity context information include, but are not limited to: the hardware of the IHS, the software of the IHS (e.g., the OS), power states and maximum clock frequencies of selected components of the IHS, peripheral devices **100A-N** coupled to the IHS, either permanently or temporarily, networks available to the IHS and the performance characteristics of those networks, software installers available on the IHS, etc.

(49) Initial productivity and security targets for instantiation of a workspace may be calculated based on the context of user's **201** actions in requesting the workspace (e.g., procedures used to identify the user) combined with the productivity and security context in which the workspace will operate. The productivity and security targets may also be based on behavioral analytics related to user **201**, IHS **100** telemetry and/or environmental information (e.g., collected via sensors **112**). In some cases, at **205**, a local management agent operating on IHS **100** may calculate initial security and productivity targets based upon the collected security and productivity context. In other cases, a remote workspace orchestrator **206A-N** may calculate security and productivity targets for instantiation of a workspace on IHS **100**.

(50) As used herein, the term “security target” generally refers to the attack surface presented by a workspace that is created and operated based on a workspace definition, while the term “productivity target” generally refers to the productivity characteristics of a particular workspace definition. Examples of a productivity target include, but are not limited to: type of data or data source available to user **201**, minimum latency of a workspace, responsiveness of the IHS **100**, etc. Attributes that may be used to characterize a security target may include, but are not limited to: a minimum security score for a workspace, a minimum trust score of IHS **100**, authentication requirements for user **201** (e.g., how many authentication factors are required, frequency of re-authentication), minimum level of trust in the network utilized by a workspace, required isolation of a workspace from other processes operating on IHS **100**, the ability to access a browser within a workspace, the ability to transfer data between workspaces, the ability to extend a primary workspace using one or more subordinate workspaces, the security context for any subordinate workspaces, etc.

(51) Moreover, the term “workspace definition” generally refers to a collection of attributes that describe aspects a workspace that may be assembled, created, and deployed in a manner that satisfies a security target (i.e., the definition provides an attack surface for the workspace that presents an acceptable level of risk) and a productivity target (e.g., data access, access requirements, upper limits on latency, etc.) in light of the security context (e.g., location, patch level, threat information, network connectivity, etc.) and the productivity context (e.g., available computing resources on IHS **100**, performance characteristics of IHS **100**, network speed, etc.) in which the workspace is to be deployed. A workspace definition may enable fluidity of migration of an instantiated workspace, since the definition supports the ability for a workspace to be assembled on any IHS according to embodiments that is configured for operation with a workspace

orchestration service.

(52) In describing capabilities and constraints of a workspace, a workspace definition **208** may prescribe one or more of: authentication requirements for user **201**, containment and/or isolation of the workspace (e.g., local application, sandbox, docker container, progressive web application or “PWA,” Virtual Desktop Infrastructure “VDI,” etc.), primary applications that can be executed in the defined containment of the workspace to enable user **201** to be productive with one or more data sources, additional applications that are included in the workspace to enhance productivity, security components that reduce the scope of the security target presented by the productivity environment (DELL DATA GUARDIAN from DELL TECHNOLOGIES INC., an anti-virus, etc.), the data sources to be accessed and requirements for routing that data to and from the workspace containment (e.g., use of VPN, minimum encryption strength), workspace capabilities to independently attach other resources, constraints on the ability to generate subordinate workspaces, descriptions of any already operating subordinate workspaces, etc.

(53) In some embodiments, workspace definition **208** selected for operation of a workspace may specify a computing architecture for use in the operation of the workspace. Such a computing architecture may be selected for use by a workspace based in part on a security context of the IHS, where this security context may account for factors such as the security posture of IHS **100**, user **201** of IHS **100**, environment **202** in which IHS **100** is being operated, and/or the information that is being accessed via the workspace. In this manner, the attack surface presented by the computing architecture in use by a workspace may be selected to be commensurate with the security context in which the workspace will operate.

(54) In some embodiments, a computing architecture in use by a workspace may include the use of one or more subordinate workspaces that may operate using the discrete logic and memory resource of devices **122A-H** that are coupled to IHS **100**, thus altering the attack surface of the workspace.

(55) In some implementations, workspace definitions may be based at least in part on static policies or rules defined, for example, by an enterprise's Information Technology (IT) Decision Maker (ITDM). In some implementations, static rules may be combined and improved upon by machine learning (ML) and/or artificial intelligence (AI) algorithms that evaluate historical productivity and security data collected as workspaces are life cycled. In this manner, rules may be dynamically modified over time to generate improved workspace definitions. If it is determined, for instance, that a user dynamically adds a text editor every time he uses MICROSOFT VISUAL STUDIO from MICROSOFT CORPORATION, then workspace orchestration service **206A-N** may autonomously add that application to the default workspace definition for that user.

(56) With respect to FIG. **2B**, during orchestration phase **200B**, the initial security and productivity targets are processed and/or reconciled against resources, device capabilities, and cloud services available, etc., to produce workspace definition at **208**. As described, a workspace definition may specify capabilities and constraints of a workspace, such as: runtime security requirements of the workspace containment (e.g., such as isolation from the OS of IHS **100** or from certain hardware of IHS **100**), the use of reference measurements to attest to the integrity of the workspace once running, applications to be provided for operation within the workspace, aggregation of resources available via the workspace, access configurations (e.g., virtual private network or “VPN”), any subordinate workspaces, one or more remote workspace orchestrators **206A-N** that are authorized to modify a workspace definition or to otherwise interface with a workspace, etc.

(57) The initial workspace definition may then be utilized by automation engine **302** of workspace orchestration service **206** to coordinate assembly **209** and instantiation **210** of a workspace using a selected computing architecture of the IHS **100** in which the workspace will operate. In cases where a workspace is cloud-hosted, automation engine **302** may assemble and instantiate a remote workspace that may be accessed via a secure connection established via a web browser or other web-based component operating on IHS **100**. In some embodiments, automation engine **302** may

resolve configuration conflicts between a workspace definition and the user's inputs in the operation of a workspace.

(58) The instantiated workspace is operated by user **201** at **211**, and new productivity and security context information related to the behavior or use of data is generated at **212**. This operation of a workspace may result in a change or new classification of data based upon what user **201** has done, accessed, and/or created, thus resulting in a change to the security context of the workspace. To the extent the user's behavioral analytics, device telemetry, and/or the environment has changed to a quantifiable degree, these changes in security context may serve as additional input for a reevaluation of the security and performance targets at **207** by automation engine **302**. Additionally, or alternatively, new workspace context, security target, and/or productivity target may be now measured against the initial targets, and the result may cause automation engine **302** to produce a new workspace definition at **208**, if appropriate.

(59) Particularly, if an instantiated workspace has parameters that fall outside of the range of the target indexes such that a difference between additional or updated context information and the initial or previous context information is scored below a threshold value, automation engine **302** may process the assembly of modifications to an existing workspace and deploy such modifications at **210**. Conversely, if the difference between the additional or updated context information and the initial or previous context information is scored above a threshold value, automation engine **302** may generate a new workspace at **210**. In generating a new workspace **210**, session data metadata and context may be preserved by data aggregation engine **336** and session data may be restored within the new workspace as applicable.

(60) Additionally, or alternatively, the method may terminate or retire the initial or previous workspace at **213**, as part of termination phase **200C**. In some cases, user action may initiate the termination process (e.g., user **201** closes application or browser accessing data) and/or termination may take place automatically as part of an adjustment in workspace definition (e.g., the isolated environment is instructed to terminate by automation engine **302**). Still as part of termination phase **200C**, workspace resources of IHS **100** and/or at workspace orchestration service **206** may be released.

(61) As indicated in FIG. 2B, orchestration phase **200B** may include the use of multiple remote workspace orchestrators **206A-N** that participate in the launching and operation of a workspace on an IHS **100**. In various embodiments, any number of remote workspace orchestrators **206A-N** may participate in the ongoing operation of a workspace. For instance, remote workspace orchestrator **206A** may be operated by the manufacturer of IHS **100** and may support configuration of a workspace on IHS **100** that provides the user with a launch point for requesting access to protected resources. Through this launch point, a user may select access to protected corporate data, such as a spreadsheet that includes protected corporate financial information. Based on this selection, a local management agent operating on IHS **100** may invoke a corporate remote workspace orchestrator **206B** that provides a workspace definition for use in configuring and operating a new workspace on IHS **100** that provides protected access to the requested spreadsheet.

(62) In one scenario, safely accessing the requested spreadsheet may require installation of an updated spreadsheet program on IHS **100**. In this scenario, the local management agent of IHS **100** may invoke third remote workspace orchestrator **206N** for initiating an update to the spreadsheet program that is available through the workspace. In this manner, various remote workspace orchestrators **206A-N** may support the deployment and ongoing operation of workspaces on IHS **100**.

(63) As such, in various embodiments, the method of FIGS. 2A and 2B enables secure user productivity even when a workspace operates on an IHS or cloud platform that is not under direct management. Such method also provides for dynamic or adaptive configurations and policies allowing for the best possible user experience while maintaining appropriate level of security. In some cases, the definition of a productivity environment and access requirements may be selected

based upon productivity and security dependencies and targets, and the definition of capabilities related to the workspace may be adaptive in nature. Particularly, workspace definition attributes may be dynamically selected based upon historical productivity and security information, based upon each individual user or group's behavior.

(64) FIGS. 3A and 3B show a diagram of an example of system components **300A** and **300B** (collectively referred to as “system **300**”) configured for the operation of subordinate workspaces on an IHS. Particularly, system **300** may include one or more IHSs remotely located and/or networked having program instructions stored thereon that, upon execution, cause the one or more IHSs to perform various workspace orchestration operations described herein, including, but not limited to: the dynamic evaluation of security and productivity targets based upon updated context information received from IHS **100**, the calculation of risk scores and other productivity and security metrics based on ongoing collection of context information, the generation of workspace definitions, and the assembly of one or more files or policies that enable the instantiation of a workspace in accordance with a workspace definition at a cloud service and/or IHS **100**.

(65) System **300** may include program instructions that, upon execution, cause IHS **100** to perform various local management operations described herein, including, but not limited to, the collection of productivity and security context information, the calculation of productivity scores and/or risk scores, the instantiation, execution, and modification of a workspace based upon files, definitions, or policies, such as workspace definitions.

(66) Components **300A** and **300B** of system **300** may be coupled to and/or in communication with each other via any suitable network technology and/or protocol, which allows workspace orchestration service **206** to be remotely provided with respect to local management agent **332**. As described with regard to FIG. 1, an IHS **100** according to embodiments may include a component such as a trusted controller that may support certain secure out-of-band communications that are independent from the OS of IHS **100**. In some embodiments, such a trusted controller may be configured to support deployment and operation of local management agent **332** and/or to report changes in context to workspace orchestration service **206**.

(67) As described with regard to FIGS. 2A and 2B, multiple workspace orchestration services **206A-N** may be operate in support of a workspaces. Accordingly, workspace orchestration service illustrated in FIG. 3A may correspond to any of these individual workspace orchestration services **206A-N**, where each of these workspace orchestration services may include any of all of the components and systems described with regard to FIG. 3A. In some embodiments, orchestration of an individual workspace operating on IHS **100** may be transferred between different workspace orchestration services throughout the lifecycle of the workspace.

(68) For instance, a workspace may be configured and initialized based on a workspace definition provided by a workspace orchestration service that is operated by the manufacturer of IHS **100**. However, during ongoing operation of this particular workspace, orchestration of the workspace may be transferred to a workspace orchestration service operated by an entity that employs the user of IHS **100**. Further operation of this workspace may then result in orchestration being transferred to a workspace orchestration service operated by a provider of software operating on the IHS, such as by the provider of an operating system of IHS **100**.

(69) As illustrated in system **300A** of FIG. 3A, workspace orchestration service **206** may include a number of sub-components that support deployment and ongoing evaluation and adaptation of workspaces on IHS **100**. Embodiments of workspace orchestration service **206** may include systems that may support: web services **306**, manufacturer integration **317**, and analytics services **323**. Moreover, web services **306** may comprise application services **301** and user interface (UI) and automation services **302**.

(70) Analytics services **323** may be configured to receive and process context information from IHS **100**, both during initial configuration of a workspace and in ongoing support of workspaces, and to provide that information, along with any analytics generated, to context logic **303** of

application services **301**. Based on information collected during the deployment and ongoing support of workspaces, support assistance intelligence engine (SAIE) **324** may be configured to generate and/or analyze technical support information (e.g., updates, errors, support logs, etc.) for use in diagnosing and repairing workspace issues.

(71) Workspace insights and telemetry engine **325** may be configured to analyze and/or produce device-centric, historical, and behavior-based data (e.g., hardware measurements, use of features, settings, etc.) resulting from the operation of workspaces.

(72) Workspace intelligence module **326** may include any suitable intelligence engine, such as machine learning models, for processing and evaluating collected context data to identify patterns and tendencies in the operation of workspaces and in the adaptation of workspaces based on context changes.

(73) Application services **306** system of workspace orchestration service **206** includes UI and automation services **302** system that may include context logic module **303**, classification policy **304**, and condition control module **305**. Context logic module **303** may support processing of context information in making risk assessments (e.g., evaluating the risk associated requests by the user against the context of the user's behavior, history of the user's IHS, capabilities of the user's IHS, and environmental conditions). For instance, security context information collected by IHS **100** may be provided to workspace orchestration service **206** where it may be used, such as by context logic **303**, to calculate a risk score associated with a request for use of a managed data source and/or application.

(74) Classification policy **304** may include administrator and machine-learning defined policies describing risk classifications associated with different security contexts, such as risk classifications for specific data, locations, environments, IHSs, logical environments, risk classifications for subordinate workspace topologies, or user actions (e.g., use of high-risk data requires use of a workspace definition suitable for use with a risk score above a specific value).

(75) Condition control module **305** may include intelligence providing automated decision making for appropriately aligning risk and context. In some cases, condition control module **305** may dynamically deploy a solution to address any detected misalignment of risk and context.

(76) For instance, upon requesting access to a highly classified data source that results in a significant increase in risk score, the condition control module **305** may select workspace definition modifications that implement security procedures that are suitable for the higher risk score. In another example, based on hardware resources available on an IHS **100**, the condition control module **305** may determine a risk score for an existing workspace operating on the IHS may be lowered through adaptation of the workspace into a primary workspace that operates using the main hardware resources of the IHS and one or more subordinate workspaces that operate on discrete external hardware components coupled to IHS **100**.

(77) Application services **301** may include a group of web services **306** called on by UI and automation services **302** to support various aspects of the orchestration of workspaces. Particularly, web services **306** may include application and workspace services **307** that may assemble and package applications for deployment in a workspace (e.g., an ".msix" file packaged and deployed to a MICROSOFT HYPER-V container). In some embodiments, a workspace definition may be used to specify whether a user will be provided access to an application in this manner.

(78) Web services **306** may also include a tenant subscription module **308**, that performs dynamic configuration of an IHS and deployment of the described workspace orchestration services at the point-of-sale (POS) of an IHS, or of hardware or software components purchased for installation in the IHS.

(79) License tracking module **309** may be used to maintain and track license information or other entitlement credentials for software, services, and IHSs.

(80) Access control module **310** may specify policies used in controlling access to data and applications by authorized users.

- (81) Unified Endpoint Management (UEM) module **311** may be configured to support the described orchestration of workspaces on various IHSs that may be utilized by a particular user.
- (82) Web services **306** that may be used in support of workspaces may further include resource provisioning services **312** for configuring an IHS or workspace with secrets/credentials necessary to access specific resources (e.g., credentials for use of VPNs, networks, data storage repositories, workspace encryption, workspace attestation, and workspace-to-device anchoring).
- (83) In some cases, resource provisioning services **312** may include secrets provisioned as part of a trusted assembly process of IHS **100** and, in some instances, associated with a unique identifier **348** of the IHS **100**.
- (84) Web services **306** may also include an authorization/token module that provides identity functions and may connect to various authentication sources, such as, for example, Active Directory.
- (85) Endpoint registration module **314** may be configured to register IHSs and/or workspaces with management service that tracks the use of the described workspace orchestration.
- (86) In some scenarios, directory services **315** module may be configured to provide active directory services (e.g., AZURE ACTIVE DIRECTORY from MICROSOFT).
- (87) Device configuration services **316** enable central configuration, monitoring, managing, and optimization of workspaces that in certain contexts may operate remotely from an IHS and may only present the user of the IHS with an image of the workspace output. In cooperation with resource provisioning services **312**, device configuration services **316** may also handle secret creation and IHS configuration.
- (88) Still referring to FIG. 3A, manufacturer integration components **317** may communicate with application services **301** and client IHS **100** to provide features that are usable during workspace evaluation and instantiation, where these features are based upon information available to the manufacturer of client IHS **100**.
- (89) For instance, certificate authority **318** may include or provide access to a certificate authority that issues digital certificates that may be used in validating the authenticity and integrity of the hardware of IHS **100**.
- (90) Identity service module or engine **319** may be configured to manage the identity of a user and/or owner of an IHS, as well as brokering user identification for utilizing and updated customer directory **322**.
- (91) Order entitlement module **320** may be responsible for managing the entitlements purchased as well as the associated issued certificates, that may include certificates signed by a certificate authority **318**.
- (92) Ownership repository **321** may manage user entitlements associated with IHSs and their ownership and may provide support for users transferring ownership of an IHS and conveying the entitlements associated with that IHS. In certain scenarios, ownership repository **321** may use this transfer of ownership to decommission the secrets associated with the entitlements embedded in the IHS.
- (93) Customer directory **322** may be configured to authenticate and authorize all users and IHSs in a network, such as assigning and enforcing security policies for all IHSs and installing or updating software (in some cases, customer directory **322** may work in cooperation and/or may be the same as directory services **315**).
- (94) Referring now to FIG. 3B, in some embodiments, IHS **100** may be configured to operate local management agent **332** that may run within a secure execution environment **345** hosted by trusted controller **341**, such as trusted controller **115** of FIG. 1. In other embodiments, local management agent **332** may operate as a trusted and attestable process of the OS of IHS **100**.
- (95) In some embodiments, local management agent **332** may include a workspace engine suitable for instantiating and managing the operation of one or more workspaces **331A-N** on IHS **100**. As described, the capabilities of a workspace may be modified based on changes in the productivity

and security contexts in which the workspace is operating. Accordingly, depending on the context in which the workspace is operating, the workload(s) in each of workspaces **331A-N** may be hosted in a public cloud, a private cloud, a specific server, using various topologies of subordinate workspace, or locally hosted in full or in part on IHS **100**. These allocations of computing resources that comprise the computing architecture for each particular workspace **331A-N** may be individually prescribed by the respective workspace definition that is used to build and operate each workspace.

(96) As described, the workspace definition may be created by workspace orchestration service **206** based upon context information provided by IHS **100**, security targets for each workspace **331A-N**, and productivity targets for each workspace **331A-N**.

(97) In some embodiments, local management agent **332** may be configured to host, launch, and/or execute a workspace hub **327** that provides a launch point **203** by which user's initiate workspaces through the selection of managed data and resources. In various embodiments, launch point **203** may be an agent, application, special-purpose workspace or web portal the provides an interface by which a user may select from an aggregated collection of data sources, applications, calendars, messages or other managed information or resources that are available to the user of IHS **100** via operation of a workspace as described herein. In various embodiments, the launch point **203** may be provided in the form for textual, graphical and/or audio user interfaces that allow a user of IHS **100** to select available data and/or resources. In some embodiments, workspace hub **327** may utilize a local environment management module **328** in providing the workspace interface that is presented to the user on IHS **100** and doing so in a consistent manner across workspaces **331A-N**. Workspace hub **327** may also include a local intelligence logic **329** used to support modeling the use of IHS **100** in order to improve characterization of the actual risk associated with a risk context. User authentication and access control operations may be performed by a local identity module **330** that may interface with trusted controller **341** in providing user authentication.

(98) In some cases, each instantiated workspace **331A-N** may be a logical environment that provides a user with access to requested data or applications, where the environment may operating using a computing architecture that may be isolated in varying degrees from the hardware and software of IHS **100** based on the security context and productivity context in which each workspace **331A-N** is operating. In some instances, the selection of a data source or resource that are available to user via launch point **203** may result in launching a new workspace. For instance, if a user launches a browser through selection of an icon displayed by launch point **203**, a new workspace may be created and launched according to a workspace definition that has been selected for providing the user access to a web browser in the security and productivity contexts in which the request has been made. In a scenario where the user double clicks on a confidential presentation file available from a data source that is provided by launch point **203**, an additional workspace may be instantiated with a presentation application providing access to the requested presentation file, where this new workspace is created based on a workspace definition that provided appropriate security for accessing that particular confidential presentation on that particular IHS. In other instances, a selection of the presentation file by a user may result in the presentation being made available through the existing workspace, in some cases using the existing workspace definition and, in other cases, using a workspace definition that has been modified to support the requested access to the confidential presentation file.

(99) Although workspaces **331A-N** supported by IHS **330B** may each be isolated to varying degrees from the hardware and/or software of IHS **100** and from each other, a user of IHS **330B** may expect to be able to operate the multiple workspaces **331A-N** in a manner that allows content to be transferred between the different workspaces **331A-N**. For instance, a user may select a portion of the data displayed in workspace **331A** and utilize OS or other workspace functions to copy the data for copying to workspace **331B**.

(100) In various embodiments, local management agent **332** may operate in full or in part on secure

platform **345** hosted by trusted controller **341**, such as described with regard to FIG. 1, that operates independent from the OS of IHS **100**. In some embodiments, all or part of local management agent **332** may operate as trusted components of the OS of IHS **100**. To execute the various operations described herein, local management agent **332** may include command monitor **334** configured to provide instrumentation to receive commands from workspace orchestration service **206** in support of the workspaces operating on the IHS. For instance, such commands supported by local management agent **332** may provide for a new workspace definition to be specified for an individual workspace **331A-N**, such as through a new workspace definition that reconfigures use of existing IHS resources into a primary workspace and one or more subordinate workspaces, where the primary workspaces and each of the subordinate workspace all operate according to their own respective workspace definitions. In some embodiments, command monitor **334** may be reconfigured to interface with different workspace orchestration services in support of the ability to transfer orchestration of an individual workspace **331A-N** between different workspace orchestration services.

(101) Local management agent **332** may also include telemetry module **335** that may be configured for communicating collected information to workspace orchestration service **206**, including IHS resource availability and including reporting changes in context that may warrant adjustments to workspaces **331A-N**. Data aggregator **336** may track all of the data source and other resources (e.g., applications, local or cloud-based services) that may be provided to the user via a workspace.

(102) Local management agent **332** may utilize resource manager module **337** that is configured to manage access to data, network configuration, such as for VPNs and network access, identity information, access control, and resource provisioning services. Security module **338** may be configured to provide various security services.

(103) BIOS interface **339** may provide a secure BIOS interface used for accessing and managing credentials in secure object storage.

(104) BIOS analytics module **340** may be configured to perform forensic services for BIOS telemetry and health assessments.

(105) Persistence module **346** may be configured to support persistence of applications entitled at a POS or assigned by administrators and supported with required license tracking.

(106) Workspace attestation module **333** may provide a platform centric service layer on top of a container engine provided by local management agent **332** and may be used to measure and attest workspaces **331A-N** in any suitable manner defined or orchestrated by a condition control module **305** of a workspace orchestrator **206**.

(107) As part of secure platform **345**, native management module **347** may be configured to enable an out-of-band management interface for interoperation with workspace orchestration service **206**, where this OOB interface operates independent from the OS of IHS **100**, as described with regard to FIG. 1.

(108) In some embodiments, the OOB management interface supported by native management module **347** may be utilized by device configuration services **316** of the workspace orchestration service to access the secure platform services **345** of IHS **100**, thus providing a reliable mechanism for workspace orchestration service **206** to interface with IHS **100**, and more particularly to the resources of the IHS that are being used to operate workspaces **331A-N**.

(109) Digital device ID module **348** may provide a unique, un-spoofable, cryptographically bound identifier. In embodiments supporting secure platform **345**, secure embedded controller **341** may be a hardened hardware module that may include root of trust module **342** configured as a trusted data store and, in some cases for cryptographic processing, that may be trusted within a cryptographic system.

(110) Device attestation service **343** may be configured to perform device assurance and trust services (e.g., secure BIOS and secure boot, etc.).

(111) Secure object store **344** may be provided that is configured to lock and access keys, hashes,

and/or other secrets in an EC and/or TPM.

(112) In some scenarios, IHS **100** may be provisioned by a manufacturer that also controls manufacturer integration components **317**, workspace attestation module **333** may operate in conjunction with secure object store **342**, authenticated BIOS module **339**, and/or digital device identity module **348**, etc., to further secure and/or control productivity features available in any of workspaces **331A-N** based upon hardware devices and settings unique to that IHS and/or designed specifically by that manufacturer.

(113) To further illustrate how the systems and methods described herein operate to modernize workspace and hardware lifecycle management in an enterprise productivity ecosystem, three non-limiting use cases or examples are discussed in turn below.

Use Case A

(114) In use case A, a user employed by an enterprise may request access to a protected data source while on the enterprise's premise and while using an enterprise-owned and configured notebook computer, which may be configured as described with regard to IHS **100** of FIG. **1** and client IHS **100** of FIG. **3B**.

(115) In response to the request, a local management agent **332** operating on the user's notebook retrieves information describing the current context in which the protected data will be accessed and calculates security and productivity targets based on the determined context information. In this use case, the local management agent may have been installed on the IHS by an IT administrator, and may operate as background service. When the user selects the protected data, such as via a launch point selection provided by the OS of the notebook, the local management agent notifies a workspace orchestration service provided by the enterprise of the request for access to the protected data. In response, workspace orchestration service of the enterprise generates a workspace definition for generating and operating a workspace on the IHS by which the user may be provided access to the protected data. One received at the IHS, the protected data may be restricted for access only by a specific workspace based on file classification (e.g., file metadata/type/properties/permissions, folder location, encrypted region, etc.). Throughout use of the protected data, the local management agent may collect context information, some or all of which may be sent to the orchestration service for use in updating the risk and productivity scores of the workspace.

(116) In this example, the workspace orchestration service may determine the context to have an overall security risk of "2," in some instances using a weighed, machine learning, or artificial intelligence algorithm. This overall security risk of 2 may be based upon the locale (e.g., an enterprise locale with a lowest risk score of 1), user identity (e.g., a high-confidence identification of a sophisticated user, such as a known user with a history without significant security protocol violations has a low risk score of 2), network risk (e.g., a low risk score of 1 based on use of a wired network connection controlled by the enterprise), IHS risk (e.g., a risk score of 1 based on a high level of control of an enterprise owned/managed IHS that operates known software versions with security features enabled); regulatory risk (e.g., a risk score of 1 based on that lack of any regulatory restrictions on this particular data, such as restrictions with respect to General Data Protection Regulation or "GDPR," Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act "HIPAA," Payment Card Industry "PCI," technology export regulation, etc.), and data type (e.g., a risk score of 8 based on the requested data being stored in a confidential datafile).

(117) In evaluating the request, the workspace orchestration service may also calculate a productivity score of "9," also using a weighed, machine learning, or artificial intelligence algorithm. This productivity score of 9 may be based upon the locale e.g., a score of 10 based on use of the data at a location of the enterprise), user identity (e.g., a score of 9 in light of a "skilled" classification of the user based on advanced compute tasks by the user, proficiency of the user, and/or speed of operation by the user), network speed/latency (e.g., a score of 10 based on use of fast, wired, Gigabit Ethernet supported by the enterprise's internal network), IHS performance (e.g.,

a score of 8 base the speed of the CPU, expense of the CPU, memory availability, graphics processing capabilities, storage) and data type (e.g., a score of 10 based on the protected data being made available as a local file in protected memory that is easy to read/write with low latency and high performance on local storage).

(118) Based upon the security score and/or context information, the workspace orchestration service builds a workspace definition file having any suitable structure with workspace definition attributes in a machine-readable format (e.g., JSON name-value, XML structured, etc.). In this example, the security target may be deemed to have a value of “1” based upon a combination of attributes values representing loads, needs, or demands on security controls and containment features that may include: threat monitoring: 1 (low demand); threat detection: 1 (low demand); threat analytics: 1 (low demand); threat response: 1 (low demand); storage confidentiality: 2 (low); storage integrity: 2 (low); network confidentiality: 1 (low); network integrity: 1 (low); memory confidentiality: 1 (low); memory integrity: 1 (low); display confidentiality: 1 (low); display integrity: 1 (low); user authentication: 1 (low, basic password is fine, non-multifactor authentication or “MFA,” no session expiration); IT administrator scope: 1 (administrator manages remotely but does not need heavy remediation software; and regulatory compliance: 1 (no GDPR, No HIPAA, no PCI, no tech export restriction, etc.).

(119) Based upon the productivity target and/or context information, a productivity target for the workspace definition may be deemed to have a value of “9” (defining a high-quality, responsive user experience) based upon a combination of attribute values representing productivity requirements as follows: local storage: 7 (partial hard drive control, some storage reserved for IT load); CPU access: 10 (unlimited); local graphics: 10 (unlimited); and application stack: 10 (can use applications, install applications that the user needs, give them administrator rights, etc.).

(120) Third, after the workspace definition is complete, the workspace orchestration service and the local management agent may assemble the workspace and instantiate it for the user. For example, the local management agent may receive definition files (e.g., JSON, XML, etc.) from the orchestration service, and it may parse the file to implement security risk controls such as: threat monitoring: 1 (local management agent does not install threat, detection, and response or “TDR” software); threat detection: 1 (local management agent does not install TDR software); threat analytics: 1 (orchestration does not need to gather detailed telemetry from the system, OS will not be enrolled in logging); threat response: 1 (local management agent does not install security threat response agent); storage confidentiality: 2 (local management agent deploys a local file-system encryption product that the user can optionally enable on specific files as needed with right-click context menus); storage integrity: 2; network confidentiality: 1 (local management agent confirms basic firewall configuration is correct—e.g., IT GPO-controlled); network integrity: 1; memory confidentiality: 1 (local management agent confirms configuration—e.g., No SGX, TXT, or container/sandbox software deployed); memory integrity: 1; display confidentiality: 1 (local management agent confirms graphics drivers installed, privacy screen and camera optionally managed by user); display integrity: 1; user authentication: 1 (local agent confirms basic GPO password rules are configured, and met by user—e.g., number of characters, no session expiration, etc.); IT administrator scope: 1 (local agent runs with system privilege, confirms IT admin accounts are listed in local admin user group—e.g., per GPO); and regulatory compliance: 1 (local agent does not install any compliance assistance software).

(121) After confirming the configuration, the workspace orchestration service and the local management agent may give the user access to the requested local confidential file, and the user may begin working in a newly created workspace.

Use-Case B

(122) In use-case B, a user may request access to a confidential datafile while at a coffee shop using an open public network and an IT-managed/owned PC, such configured as described with regard to IHS **100** of FIG. **1** and client IHS **100** of FIG. **3B**.

(123) First, a local management agent **332** executed by client IHS **100** retrieves the requested context and calculates security and productivity scores based on context. In this use-case, the local management agent may have been installed by IT, and it may be running in the background as a service. The confidential data may be kept on a shared IT-managed network resource on-premises (e.g., back in a main corporate office), and the local management agent may be responsible for monitoring when this data path is requested by the user (e.g., the user hits a specific URL, IP, etc.). Moreover, the local management agent may continuously collect all context and send it to the workspace orchestration service to assist in scoring processes later (this may also be done at the time of the user's access request or indication of intent, rather than a continuous collection).

(124) When the user selects the desired confidential datafile, client IHS **100**'s OS calls the local management agent associated with the path to the confidential datafile and calls back to a remote workspace orchestration service **206** to request a workspace definition.

(125) In this example, the workspace orchestration service may score an overall security risk to have a value of “4,” using a weighed, machine learning, or artificial intelligence algorithm, based upon the following context information or inputs, each of which is also given as a risk metric based upon a selected policy: locale: 5 (public, safe country); user persona: 5 (new user, classification data does not exist yet); network risk: 5 (medium, public but common location, wireless connection detected); device risk: 1 (high level of control, corporate owned/managed platform, known versions, security features enabled, etc.); and regulatory: 1 (based on user, data, location combinations—e.g., no restrictions with respect to General Data Protection Regulation or “GDPR,” Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act “HIPAA,” Payment Card Industry “PCI,” technology export, etc.).

(126) The workspace orchestration service may also calculate a productivity score to have a value of “5,” using a weighed, machine learning, or artificial intelligence algorithm, based upon context information or inputs, each of which is also given as a resource metric based upon a selected policy. For instance, security contexts inputs may include: locale: 6 (remote location but in USA major city, in a public area, non-employees are within visual/audio range of device); user persona: 5 (unknown confidence “null” classification, uses default onboarding assumptions); network speed/latency: 4 (medium, wireless but AC on shared network); and device performance: 8 (fast, expensive CPU, memory, graphics, but storage only needs ~<10 GB).

(127) Second, based upon the security score and/or context information, the workspace orchestration service builds a workspace definition file having any suitable structure with workspace definition attributes in a machine-readable format (e.g., JSON name-value, XML structured, etc.). In this example, a security target may be deemed to have a value of “4” based upon a combination of attributes values representing loads, needs, or demands on security controls and containment features as follows: threat monitoring: 4 (medium demand); threat detection: 4 (medium demand); threat analytics: 4 (medium demand); threat response: 4 (medium demand); storage confidentiality: 4 (medium); storage integrity: 9 (high); network confidentiality: 5 (medium); network integrity: 2 (low); memory confidentiality: 4 (medium); memory integrity: 8 (high); display confidentiality: 7 (medium/high—worried about “shoulder surfers” reading data from an adjacent seat or table nearby, public location) display integrity: 2 (low); user authentication: 4 (medium, two-factor authentication using a hardware token, session expiration upon sleep, screen lock, or logout); IT administration scope: 3 (administrator can monitor, manage, and remediate remotely if the user calls them for help with IT issues); and regulatory compliance: 1 (no GDPR, No HIPAA, no PCI, no tech export restriction, etc.).

(128) Based upon the productivity target and/or context information, a productivity target for the workspace definition may be deemed to have a value of 7 (defining a high-quality, responsive user experience) based upon a combination of attribute values representing productivity requirements as follows: local storage: 7 (partial hard drive control, some storage reserved for IT load); CPU access: 10 (unlimited); local graphics: 10 (unlimited); and application stack: 7 (can use

applications, can install some IT-approved applications that the user needs, but no administrator rights, because the user cannot be trusted to install only valid/safe productivity software, but can install pre-approved IT applications as needed).

(129) Third, after the workspace definition is complete, the workspace orchestration service and the local management agent may assemble the workspace and instantiate it for the user. For example, the local management agent may receive definition files (e.g., JSON, XML, etc.) from the orchestration service, and it may parse the file to implement security risk controls such as: threat monitoring: 5 (local management agent installs or confirms prior installation/configuration of TDR software); threat detection: 5 (local management agent installs or confirms prior installation/configuration of TDR software); threat analytics: 5 (orchestration confirms telemetry is accessible, OS will be enrolled in logging if not already enrolled); threat response: 2 (local management agent downloads but does not run remote incident response application—preparation in case incident is detected); storage confidentiality: 5 (local management agent deploys a local container technology, such as sandbox, with restricted “save” permissions such that the confidential files will not be allowed to save locally on the PC, but can be accessed as long as the session is active in memory); storage integrity: 5; network confidentiality: 5 (local management agent steps up firewall protections, disabling all unnecessary ports, and establishes a VPN back to the corporate office for protecting traffic to the local sandbox); network integrity: 5; memory confidentiality: 5 (local management agent configures sandbox container to isolate application and data from other applications/threats that may infiltrate the host OS); memory integrity: 5; display confidentiality: 7 (local management agent confirms graphics drivers installed, enforces privacy screen and uses camera to detect specific onlooker threats); display integrity: 7; user authentication: 4 (local agent confirms basic GPO password rules are configured, and met by user—e.g., number of characters, no session expiration, etc., but also adds in a requirement for hardware token to log in and again to establish network); IT administrator scope: 4 (local agent runs with administrator and remote access privilege, confirms IT admin accounts are listed in local admin user group—e.g., per GPO); and regulatory compliance: 4 (local agent installs state specific rule enforcement or monitoring software).

(130) After confirming the configuration, the workspace orchestration service and the local management agent may give the user access to the requested local confidential file, and the user may begin working in a newly created workspace.

Use-Case C

(131) In use-case C, a user may request access to a confidential datafile in a web hosted remote portal using a browser from Kazakhstan, while at an internet café with a borrowed/rented PC, such configured as described with regard to IHS **100** of FIG. **1** and client IHS **100** of FIG. **3B**, on an open Wi-Fi network.

(132) First, a remote workspace orchestration service **332** intercepts the access request and evaluates the browser and user context, and calculates security and productivity scores. In this use-case, there is no local management agent; all that is known is the browser and any telemetry returned or garnered through the HTTP/S session. Assume, for sake of this example, that the confidential data may kept on a shared IT-managed network resource on-premises (e.g., back in a main corporate office) and that the datafile will remain there with only remote rendering/access privileges. Web-based context may be gathered through the browser session or supplied by the user. Moreover, user context may also be collected for the workspace orchestration service through alternate side-channels (e.g., travel calendar information, recent user billing activity on corporate credit card, phone call logs, and/or location data).

(133) When the user selects the desired confidential datafile from the web browser, the back-end web server infrastructure calls back to the workspace orchestration service to request a workspace definition.

(134) In this example, the workspace orchestration service may score an overall security risk to

have a value of 9, using a weighed, machine learning, or artificial intelligence algorithm, based upon the following context information or inputs, each of which is also scored as a risk metric based upon a selected policy: locale (e.g., a risk score of 9 for operation of the IHS in Kazakhstan); user persona: 1 (user was expected to be there, the timing seems right based upon past logins, and he has a biometric watch communicator proving he is alive, himself, and located where he says he is—so that IT can always trust him); network risk: 9 (high, public and in a very obscure place); device risk: 9 (zero trust); and regulatory: 8 (based on user, data, location combinations).

(135) The workspace orchestration service may also calculate a productivity score to have a value of 5, using a weighed, machine learning, or artificial intelligence algorithm, based upon the following context information or inputs, each of which is also given as a resource metric based upon a selected policy: locale: 3 (internet café device without great performance); user persona: 9 (known high-confidence and “skilled” classification—advanced compute tasks, proficiency, and speed); network speed/latency: 3 (low quality—Wireless G from a long way away); and device performance: 3 (have to be able to tolerably browse web pages but based on what the service believes the capabilities will be, the service should build simple ones).

(136) Second, based upon the security score and/or context information, the workspace orchestration service builds a workspace definition file having any suitable structure with workspace definition attributes in a machine-readable format (e.g., JSON name-value, XML structured, etc.). In this example, a security target may be deemed to have a value of “9” based upon a combination of attributes values representing loads, needs, or demands on security controls and containment features as follows: threat monitoring: 10 (high demand, to be handled on the server side); threat detection: 10 (high demand, to be handled on the server side); threat analytics: 10 (high demand, to be handled on the server side); threat response: 10 (high demand, to be handled on the server side); storage confidentiality: 10 (high demand, to be handled on the server side); storage integrity: 8; network confidentiality: 10 (high demand, to be handled on the server side); network integrity: 9; memory confidentiality: 10 (high demand, to be handled on the server side); memory integrity: 9; display confidentiality: 10 (high, “shoulder surfers” may read datafile from an adjacent seat or table nearby in a public location); display integrity: 9; user authentication: 10 (high, three-factor authentication using login, hardware token, and biometric satellite watch—session expiration and refreshes every 30 seconds); IT administrator scope: 8 (administrator may monitor, manage, and remediate remotely if the user calls them for help or anything unexpected happens); and regulatory compliance: 10 (all network traffic is securely monitored as will the data presented).

(137) Based upon the productivity target and/or context information, a productivity target for the workspace definition may be deemed to have a value of “3” (defining a usable secure user experience primarily built for consumption and not productivity) based upon a combination of attribute values representing productivity requirements as follows: local storage: 1 (cache only); CPU access: 3 (build for limited expectations); local graphics: 3 (build for limited expectations); and application stack: 1 (web browser experience on a kiosk mode device, limited data entry capability, limited read access to need-to-know only information through VDI rendered kiosk).

(138) Third, after the workspace definition is complete, the workspace orchestration service and remote cloud web portal (e.g., session the user logged into through the browser) may assemble the workspace and instantiate it for the user in the browser. For example, the web portal may receive definition files (e.g., JSON, XML, etc.) from the orchestration service, and it may parse the file to implement security risk controls such as: threat monitoring: 9 (data center based management agent installs or confirms prior installation/configuration of TDR software); threat detection: 9 (data center based management agent installs or confirms prior installation/configuration of TDR software); threat analytics: 9 (orchestration confirms telemetry is accessible, server hosting web server may be enrolled in logging if not already enrolled—user behavioral telemetry from side channels may also be continuously monitored for suspicious/anomalous activity); threat response:

10 (data center-based management agent sets up watchdog timer to kill session automatically without periodic check-ins from orchestration, user telemetry, and web browser); storage confidentiality: 9 (data center-based management agent builds a progressive web application that may be used to display the data through a secure TLS link—the data will be rendered but only the as-needed portions of visualization presented to the user, and nothing can be saved); storage integrity: 10; network confidentiality: 9 (route traffic through best effort to secure locations—do not allow anything except bitmap renderings through the enforceable network); network integrity: 4; memory confidentiality: 9 (web page viewer only—no data leaves the data center, no confidential input is taken from the rented PC, no keyboard input is allowed, and all input may be captured from randomized virtual keyboard using mouse click coordinates); memory integrity: 8; display confidentiality: 8 (best effort to ensure confidentiality—prompt user at least—adjustable font sizes, but defaults to small fonts, obfuscated text, etc.); display integrity: 2; user authentication: 9 (local agent confirms basic password rules are configured, and met by user—e.g., number of characters, no session expiration, etc., but also adds in a requirement for hardware token and biometric, satellite watch to log in and again to establish network, requiring frequent reconfirmation from user); IT administrator scope: 7 (data center-based remote environment); and regulatory compliance: 8 (local agent does not exist but data center-based agent monitors/blocks data not appropriate). After confirming the configuration, the workspace orchestration service and the local management agent may give the user access to the requested rendered data, and the user may begin working in a newly created workspace.

(139) In various embodiments, systems and methods may be deployed for managing credentials usable in the orchestration of workspaces (e.g., **206A-N**). Particularly, in various implementations, for an orchestrator to perform management operations with respect to a workspace or workspace resource (e.g., applications, services, policies, settings, configurations, OSs, hardware devices, and features thereof), the orchestrator may need to be in possession of the appropriate credentials (e.g., password, key, certificate, etc.). For example, in connection with the instantiation of a workspace, such credentials may be provided to the orchestrator by an ITDM/OEM service or the like.

(140) There are many situations with multi-cloud managed workspaces, however, where the workspace orchestration credentials can only be maintained by one orchestrator at a time. In cases where credentials cannot be shared, to facilitate transitioning its orchestration from a first remote orchestrator to a second remote orchestrator, a workspace must transition from a managed state to an unmanaged state, and then back to managed again. In some embodiments, the process of moving through workspace lifecycle stages to allow replacement of credentials may allow multiple orchestrators to manage a single workspace without credential sharing.

(141) As used herein, the terms “domain,” “management domain,” or “orchestration domain” refer to areas of control that provide logical separation that allows or restricts access by a remote orchestrator (or a user authorized by the remote orchestrator) to a workspace, or to one or more workspace resources. Examples of workspace resources include, but are not limited to: applications, services, policies, OSs, or hardware devices. Moreover, examples of types of access requests or management operations that may be issued by users or remote orchestrators may include, but are not limited to: read, write, transforming, or configuring data or features of workspaces or workspace resources.

(142) In some cases, a workspace may be subject to management by two or more remote orchestrators concurrently or sequentially, and each orchestrator may belong to a distinct domain. For example, a first orchestrator may belong to a first domain, a second orchestrator may belong to a second domain, and the first and second domains may be mutually exclusive. As another example, the second domain may be included in the first domain, such that a first orchestrator in the first domain has access to an entire superset of resources and a second orchestrator in the second domain has access only to a subset of workspace resources. A third orchestrator in a third domain, such that the third domain is within the second domain, may have access only to a portion

of the subset of workspace resources, and so on.

(143) Within each domain, an orchestrator may have authority to issue “ownership credentials” to a user, which in turn enables the user to manage a workspace or workspace resource under that orchestrator's management oversight. Examples of “ownership credentials” may include, but are not limited to: passwords, encryption keys, and digital certificates.

(144) As used herein, the terms “password” or “passcode” refer to secret data, typically a string of characters, usually used to confirm a user's or device's (e.g., an orchestrator's) identity. An “encryption key” is a piece of information, usually a string of numbers or letters that are stored in a file, which, when processed through a cryptographic algorithm, encode or decode data.

(145) Meanwhile, the terms “digital certificate,” “public key certificate,” “identity certificate,” or simply “certificate” refer to an electronic document usable to prove the validity of a unique public-private key pair. Typically, a certificate includes information about the public key, information about the identity of its owner, and the digital signature of an entity that has verified the certificate's contents. If the signature is valid, then the orchestrator or user in possession of the private key can use that key to communicate securely with a workspace. If the signature is not valid, the orchestrator or user may be denied access to the workspace and/or workspace resource(s).

(146) In each domain, a workspace may assume one of two states: owned and unowned. If a workspace is in an “unowned state,” this means there are no users or customers to whom credentials—here referred to as ownership certificates—have been issued for that workspace's orchestrator. Conversely, if a workspace is in an “owned state,” this means that at least one user and/or orchestrator—i.e., an “owner”—has been issued a credential.

(147) When a workspace is in any given state, state transition or control transfer rules or policies may be enforced such that certain requests for credentials, whether by another orchestrator or by a user, are allowed or denied based upon: (a) the current state, (b) the next state, (c) a relationship between orchestrators or domains, or (d) selected telemetry and contextual information, as outlined in a policy, such as a state transition policy and/or workspace definition.

(148) In some embodiments, a workspace itself, using a cloud-agnostic local orchestration engine (e.g., local management agent **332**), may maintain workflow states asynchronously from remote orchestrators (e.g., **206A-N**). The workspace may use a local state transition policy to enforce state transitions in approved lifecycle directions only, thus allowing transfer of control, in a managed way, from one cloud, orchestrator, or domain to another.

(149) Additionally, or alternatively, improper or unapproved state transitions may be restricted by the policy, as enforced by the workspace, therefore preventing flows between those states. A workspace may also prohibit multiple simultaneous orchestration credentials, establishing a single orchestrator as the sole remote orchestrator during any lifecycle stage of the workspace to avoid collisions in orchestration activities.

(150) As such, systems and methods described herein allow local policy enforcement from within various workspace lifecycle stages to provide unique and secure workflows.

(151) In that regard, FIG. **4** is a diagram illustrating an example of system **400** for managing credentials usable in the orchestration of workspaces by multiple remote orchestrators. In some embodiments, system **400** may include OEM domain **401** and a plurality of orchestration domains **403A-N**. OEM domain **401** may include an OEM service that enables a workspace to assume initial, default, or un-managed state **402**, where no management credentials are available, such that the workspace remains unmanaged by any orchestrator.

(152) In this example, first orchestrator domain **403A**, second orchestrator domain **403B**, and Nth orchestrator domain **403N** may each assume one of two possible states at a time: unowned (ready) **404A-406A**, or user/customer owned **404B-406B**. Each of orchestrator domains **403A-N** may be associated with a distinct remote orchestrator. Moreover, each such orchestrator may provide credentials to other entities, such as other orchestrators or users, for allowing them to manage a workspace following a state transition policy.

(153) In some embodiments, a “state transition policy” may include a set of one or more rules that establish allowed or forbidden transitions between states **402**, **404A**, **404B**, **405A**, **405B**, **406A**, and **406B** depending upon the domain hierarchy of system **400**. Additionally, or alternatively, these rules may establish allowed or forbidden transitions between states based upon contextual or telemetry data. In some cases, a state transition policy may be associated with, included, or indicated in a workspace definition used to instantiate a workspace.

(154) In this example, second orchestrator domain **403B** is included within first orchestrator domain **403A**. Conversely, Nth orchestrator domain **403N** is exclusive of both first and second orchestrator domain. In various implementations, ITDM/OEM domain **401** is generally exclusive of any other domain. It should be understood, however, that the domain hierarchy of system **400** is shown for sake of illustration only and that others are possible.

(155) FIG. 5 is a diagram illustrating an example of method **500** for managing credentials usable in the remote orchestration of workspaces. In some embodiments, method **500** may be performed, at least in part, by IHS **100**.

(156) Particularly, method **500** starts at **501**. At **502**, method **500** may determine whether a first orchestrator (e.g., **206A**) in a first domain (e.g., **403A**) has a first credential. If not control stays at **502**. If so, at **503** method **500** may allow the first orchestrator to manage a workspace instantiated by IHS **100** or a set or workspace resources associated with the workspace (and/or the first domain) in response to the first orchestrator having the first credential.

(157) At **504**, method **500** may determine whether a second orchestrator (e.g., **206B**) in a second domain (e.g., **403B**) within the first domain has a second credential provided by the first orchestrator, for example, in response to a request from the second orchestrator to manage the workspace. If not, control returns to **502**.

(158) If so, at **505**, method **500** may allow the second orchestrator to manage the workspace or a subset of workspace resources. In some cases, the first and second orchestrators may each be operated by an ITDM, an OEM, an OS developer, and/or a third-party. The first domain may provide or restrict access to or from a first set of one or more workspace resources, and the second domain may provide or restrict access to or from a second set of one or more workspace resources.

(159) In some cases, the first and second sets of one or more workspace resources may include at least one of: an application, a service, a policy, an OS, or a hardware device. Moreover, the first set of one or more workspace resources may include the second set of one or more workspace resources.

(160) The first and second management credentials may include at least one of: a password, an encryption key, or a digital certificate. The first domain may include an ITDM/OEM domain, and the second domain may include an OS developer domain or a third-party domain.

(161) In some cases, prior to the second remote orchestration being allowed to manage the workspace at **505**, method **500** may revoke or invalidate the first credential. Also, to allow the second orchestrator to manage the workspace, method **500** may enforce a state transition policy configured to allow a selected state transition.

(162) For example, a state transition policy may be included or indicated in a workspace definition used to instantiate the workspace. The state transition policy may associate a rule with the selected state transition. The rule may refer to contextual or telemetry data. Additionally, or alternatively, to allow the second orchestrator to manage the workspace, method **500** enforce a state transition policy configured to deny a selected state transition.

(163) FIG. 6 is a diagram illustrating an example of another method **600** for managing credentials usable in the remote orchestration of workspaces. In some embodiments, method **600** may be performed, at least in part, by a first orchestrator (e.g., **206A**).

(164) Particularly, method **600** starts at **601**. At **602**, method **600** may allow the first orchestrator to manage a workspace instantiated on IHS **100** (e.g., by first orchestrator **206A**) using a first credential issued, for example, by an ITDM/OEM service. At **603**, method **600** may receive a

request from a second orchestrator (e.g., **206B**) to manage the workspace.

(165) At **604**, method **600** may determine whether the request meets a requirement indicated in a state transition policy. If not, control returns to **602**. If so, at **605** method **600** may issue a second credential to the second orchestrator.

(166) In some cases, the second credential may allow the user to manage the workspace with a same or a fewer set of privileges as the first orchestrator. Additionally, or alternatively, the first orchestrator may issue a third credential to one of its users or customers that allows the user to manage the workspace with the same or fewer set of privileges as the first orchestrator.

(167) FIG. **7** is a diagram illustrating an example of yet another method **700** for managing credentials usable in the remote orchestration of workspaces. In some embodiments, method **700** may be performed, at least in part, by a first orchestrator (e.g., **206A**).

(168) Particularly, method **700** starts at **701**. At **702**, method **700** may allow the first orchestrator to manage a workspace using a credential issued, for example, by an ITDM/OEM service. At **703**, method **700** may receive a request from a user or customer of the first or a second orchestrator (e.g., **206B**) to manage a workspace instantiated by IHS **100**. As before, here each of the orchestrators may be assigned to a respective domain, and the first orchestrator may be configured to manage the workspace using the credential.

(169) At **704**, method **700** may include determining whether the user's request meets a requirement indicated in a state transition policy applicable to a domain of the first orchestrator. If not, control returns to **702**. If so, at **705** method **700** may include issuing another credential to the user, such that the other credential enables the user to manage the workspace.

(170) The inventors hereof have recognized that, in many situations, widespread proliferation of distributed workspaces requires the deployment of additional orchestration resources. For example, when managing a globally distributed workforce, an enterprise's ITDM or OEM may find itself orchestrating workspaces subject to different restrictions and regulations, which can depend, for example, upon which country or territory a client IHS may be located at any given time.

(171) To address these, and other issues, systems and methods described herein may provide a hybrid distributed mesh orchestration system. In various embodiments, these systems and methods may include trust mechanisms that enable the distribution of orchestration workloads, thereby decentralizing management resources and also increasing resistance to certain attacks (e.g., distributed Denial-of-Service or “DDoS,” etc.).

(172) As used herein, the term “edge” refers to a network location that is closer to an endpoint than a centralized, remote “cloud.” An edge IHS, for example, is an IHS positioned to bring computation and/or data storage closer to client IHSs than a centralized, remote cloud service. In some cases, an edge IHS may perform tasks on behalf of the cloud service, thus reducing communication latency for client IHSs.

(173) The term “mesh” or “mesh network” refers to a network topology where infrastructure devices (e.g., bridges, switches, etc.) connect directly, dynamically, and non-hierarchically to as many other devices as possible and cooperate with each other to efficiently route data to and from client IHSs.

(174) In some cases, a database of workspaces (e.g., indexed by workspace IDs) may be enrolled for management and maintained in a database accessible to a remote orchestrator. During periods of delegation, or in response to delegation events (e.g., enterprise-wide updates, periods of heavy loads, detection of an intrusion attack, etc.), the remote orchestrator may authorize workspaces identified in such database to perform certain orchestration operations with respect to other workspaces.

(175) Generally, delegate workspaces are executed by edge IHSs. Additionally, or alternatively, delegate workspaces may be executed by client (endpoint) IHSs to form a mesh network of proxy orchestrators.

(176) FIG. **8** is a diagram illustrating an example of system **800** for distributed orchestration of

workspaces using delegate workspaces. In some embodiments, remote orchestrator **206A** in cloud **801** may be configured to assign management tasks and/or commands to delegate workspaces executed by IHSs **805A-N** located on edge **806** (or “edge IHSs”). To this end, remote orchestrator **206A** may include, or be in communication with, device database **802**, authorized delegate workspace database **803**, and/or command queue database **804**.

(177) In some cases, one or more of a plurality of devices identified in database **802** (e.g., client IHSs **807A-Z**, edge IHSs **805A-N**, etc.) may be selected by remote orchestrator **802A**, for example, based upon their distance from one or more client IHSs **807A-Z** that are the end target of selected management commands or tasks, so that the device **805A-N** can act upon the command or task quickly. Such distance may be determined, for example, based upon one or more of: a network address, a physical location, or a communication latency measurement, as identified in device database **802**.

(178) Among the selected devices **805A-N**, one or more delegate workspaces may be further selected, on-the-fly, to administer the management commands or tasks on behalf of remote orchestrator **206A** depending upon their type of workloads, proximity, latency, security risk score, and/or productivity risk score, as identified in authorized delegate workspace database **803**. In some cases, remote orchestrator **206A** may implement a consensus mechanism to determine trust scores, and it may select the delegate workspaces at least in part, based upon the trust scores.

(179) Management commands and tasks subject to delegation may be queued in command queue database **804**. A management command or task may be deemed subject to delegation, for example, if it requires a significant amount of time to complete (i.e., above a threshold value) compared to other commands or tasks.

(180) Examples of delegable commands or tasks in database **804** may include, but are not limited to, commands that: enable or disable a secure boot feature (whereby firmware checks the signature of each piece of boot software, including UEFI firmware drivers, EFI applications, and the OS), to enforce of telemetry collection polic(ies), deploy firmware or OS updates, unlocking certain client IHS components (e.g., BIOS), etc. In some cases, these commands or tasks may be relayed differently depending upon regulatory requirements unique to which country an edge IHS and/or client IHS **807A-Z** may be located at the time of the delegation.

(181) One or more edge IHSs **805A-N** may be located in a same orchestrator domain as remote orchestrator **206A** (e.g., **403A**), and may obtain credentials for communicating with client IHSs **807A-Z** and/or their workspaces directly from remote orchestrator **206A**. Additionally, or alternatively, edge IHSs **805A-N** may be located in a different orchestrator domain as remote orchestrator **206A** (e.g., **403A** and **403B**), and may obtain credentials from remote orchestrator **206A** through another orchestrator.

(182) In some cases, a single domain may include IHSs subject to the same regulatory requirements (e.g., by country or region). In other cases, a domain may include IHSs subject to the different regulatory requirements. As such, remote orchestrator **206A** may select different client IHSs **807A-Z**, edge IHSs **805A-N**, and/or management tasks or commands, depending upon the domain associated with each device.

(183) Again, during periods of delegation, times of heavy load, and/or in response to delegation events, remote orchestrator **806A** may authorize a delegate workspace among edge IHSs **805A-N** to assume a subset of command queue database **804** to carry out the management of workspaces executed by client IHSs **807A-Z**.

(184) FIGS. **9A-C** are diagrams illustrating examples of methods **900A-C** for distributed orchestration of workspaces using delegate workspaces. In some embodiments, method **900A** of FIG. **9A** may be performed, at least in part, by remote orchestrator **206A**. Particularly, method **900A** starts at **901**.

(185) At **902**, remote orchestrator **206A** may communicate with database of delegate workspaces **803**. At **903**, remote orchestrator **206A** may assign a management task (with respect to a client

IHS's workspace) to a delegate workspace executed by a selected edge IHS **805A-N**. At **904**, remote orchestrator **206A** may determine whether there are changes to the distance, latency, security risk score, productivity score (or any telemetry/contextual information) of the delegate workspace and/or of the managed workspace, for example, as stored in database(s) **802** and/or **803**. If so, control returns to **903**; otherwise method **900A** ends at **905**.

(186) In some cases, remote orchestrator **206A** may be operated by an ITDM, an OEM, an OS developer, or a third-party. Database of **803** may be created based, at least in part, upon enrollment processes performed, at least in part, by local agents executed by IHS **805A-N**.

(187) Remote orchestrator **206A** may communicate with database **802** of edge IHS **805A-N**, and to select an edge IHS associated with the selected delegate workspace, at least in part, based upon information stored therein. In some cases, database **802** may store an indication of a mesh network topology for edge IHS **805A-N**. Edge IHSs **805A-N** may belong to a different domain than remote orchestrator **206A**, and may receive credentials from an orchestrator other than remote orchestrator **206A** for communicating with client IHSs **207A-Z**.

(188) Remote orchestrator **206A** may also communicate with database **804** of management tasks, and to select the management task based, at least in part, upon information stored therein. The management task may include, for sake of illustration only, a BIOS command (e.g., to unlock or access a protected memory area), a telemetry collection command, a workspace termination command, a workspace instantiation command, a policy update, or a workplace definition.

(189) In some cases, remote orchestrator **206A** may select the delegate workspace, at least in part, based upon a proximity between client IHSs **207A-Z** and the selected edge IHSs **205A-N**, a security risk score associated with the delegate workspace, and/or a productivity score associated with the delegate workspace.

(190) Remote orchestrator **206A** may identify additional or fewer management tasks to be assigned to the delegate workspace, at least in part, based upon a change to the proximity, security risk score, and/or proximity score. Additionally, or alternatively, remote orchestrator **206A** may re-assign the management task to another delegate workspace executed by another edge IHS **205A-N**, at least in part, based upon the change(s).

(191) In some embodiments, method **900B** of FIG. **9B** may be performed, at least in part, by one or more of edge IHSs **805A-N**. Particularly, method **900B** starts at **906**. At **907**, edge IHS **805A-N** instantiates a delegate workspace. At **908**, edge IHSs **805A-N** send delegate workspace information (e.g., security risk score, productivity score, etc.) and/or with itself (e.g., network address, location, latency, other telemetry, etc.) to remote orchestrator **206A**. Then, at **909**, edge IHS **805A-N** processes a management task or command received from remote orchestrator **206A** targeting a workspace executed by one or more of client IHSs **207A-N**. Method **900B** then ends at **910**.

(192) In some embodiments, method **900C** of FIG. **9C** may be performed, at least in part, by one or more of client IHSs **807A-Z**. Particularly, method **900C** starts at **911**. At **912**, client IHS **807A-Z** instantiates a workspace. At **913**, client IHS **807A-Z** sends workspace information (e.g., security risk score, productivity score, etc.) and/or with itself (e.g., network address, location, latency, other telemetry, etc.) to remote orchestrator **206A**. Then, at **914**, client IHS **807A-Z** executes a management task or command relayed by one or more of edge IHSs **807A-N**. Method **900C** then ends at **915**.

(193) As such, systems and methods described herein provide a hybrid, distributed mesh orchestration system. In various implementations, such authorized, delegated management from a central, remote orchestrator may unburden servers and decentralize command/control, which is required for the unique challenges involved in the management of modern workspaces.

(194) It should be understood that various operations described herein may be implemented in software executed by processing circuitry, hardware, or a combination thereof. The order in which each operation of a given method is performed may be changed, and various operations may be added, reordered, combined, omitted, modified, etc. It is intended that the invention(s) described

herein embrace all such modifications and changes and, accordingly, the above description should be regarded in an illustrative rather than a restrictive sense.

(195) The terms “tangible” and “non-transitory,” as used herein, are intended to describe a computer-readable storage medium (or “memory”) excluding propagating electromagnetic signals; but are not intended to otherwise limit the type of physical computer-readable storage device that is encompassed by the phrase computer-readable medium or memory. For instance, the terms “non-transitory computer readable medium” or “tangible memory” are intended to encompass types of storage devices that do not necessarily store information permanently, including, for example, RAM. Program instructions and data stored on a tangible computer-accessible storage medium in non-transitory form may afterwards be transmitted by transmission media or signals such as electrical, electromagnetic, or digital signals, which may be conveyed via a communication medium such as a network and/or a wireless link.

(196) Unless stated otherwise, terms such as “first” and “second” are used to arbitrarily distinguish between the elements such terms describe. Thus, these terms are not necessarily intended to indicate temporal or other prioritization of such elements. The terms “coupled” or “operably coupled” are defined as connected, although not necessarily directly, and not necessarily mechanically. The terms “a” and “an” are defined as one or more unless stated otherwise. The terms “comprise” (and any form of comprise, such as “comprises” and “comprising”), “have” (and any form of have, such as “has” and “having”), “include” (and any form of include, such as “includes” and “including”) and “contain” (and any form of contain, such as “contains” and “containing”) are open-ended linking verbs. As a result, a system, device, or apparatus that “comprises,” “has,” “includes” or “contains” one or more elements possesses those one or more elements but is not limited to possessing only those one or more elements. Similarly, a method or process that “comprises,” “has,” “includes” or “contains” one or more operations possesses those one or more operations but is not limited to possessing only those one or more operations.

(197) Although the invention(s) is/are described herein with reference to specific embodiments, various modifications and changes can be made without departing from the scope of the present invention(s), as set forth in the claims below. Accordingly, the specification and figures are to be regarded in an illustrative rather than a restrictive sense, and all such modifications are intended to be included within the scope of the present invention(s). Any benefits, advantages, or solutions to problems that are described herein with regard to specific embodiments are not intended to be construed as a critical, required, or essential feature or element of any or all the claims.

Claims

1. A remote orchestrator with respect to a workspace executed by a client Information Handling System (IHS), the remote orchestrator comprising: a processor; and a memory coupled to the processor, the memory having program instructions stored thereon that, upon execution by the processor, cause the remote orchestrator to: communicate with a database of delegate workspaces, each delegate workspace instantiated by a respective one of a plurality of edge IHSs; assign a management task with respect to a client IHS's workspace to a delegate workspace executed by a selected edge IHS, wherein the delegate workspace is selected, at least in part, based upon information stored in the database; calculate a security target and a productivity target based upon context information; and create a workspace definition based upon the security target and the productivity target; wherein the remote orchestrator is configured to transmit a file to the selected edge IHS that enables instantiation of the delegate workspace based upon the workspace definition.
2. The remote orchestrator of claim 1, wherein the remote orchestrator is operated by an entity selected from the group consisting of: an Information Technology Decision Maker (ITDM), an Original Equipment Manufacturer (OEM), a workspace management software developer, and a third-party.

3. The remote orchestrator of claim 1, wherein the database of delegate workspaces is created based, at least in part, upon enrollment processes performed, at least in part, by local agents executed by the plurality of edge IHSs.
4. The remote orchestrator of claim 1, wherein the program instructions, upon execution, further cause the remote orchestrator to communicate with another database of edge IHSs, and to select an edge IHS associated with the selected delegate workspace.
5. The remote orchestrator of claim 4, wherein the other database is configured to maintain an indication of a mesh network topology for the edge IHSs.
6. The remote orchestrator of claim 1, wherein the edge IHS belongs to a different domain than the remote orchestrator, and wherein the remote orchestrator is configured to provide credentials to the edge IHS via another remote orchestrator for communicating with the client IHS.
7. The remote orchestrator of claim 1, wherein the program instructions, upon execution, further cause the remote orchestrator to communicate with another database of management tasks, and to select the management task.
8. The remote orchestrator of claim 1, wherein the management task comprises at least one of: a Basic Input/Output System (BIOS) command, a telemetry collection command, a workspace termination command, a workspace instantiation command, a policy update, or a workspace definition change.
9. The remote orchestrator of claim 1, wherein the program instructions, upon execution, further cause the remote orchestrator to select the delegate workspace, at least in part, based upon a proximity between the client IHS and the selected edge IHS.
10. The remote orchestrator of claim 1, wherein the program instructions, upon execution, further cause the remote orchestrator to select the delegate workspace, at least in part, based upon a security risk score associated with the delegate workspace.
11. The remote orchestrator of claim 10, wherein the program instructions, upon execution, further cause the remote orchestrator to identify additional or fewer management tasks to be assigned to the delegate workspace, at least in part, based upon a change to the security risk score.
12. The remote orchestrator of claim 10, wherein the program instructions, upon execution, further cause the remote orchestrator to re-assign the management task to another delegate workspace executed by another edge IHS, at least in part, based upon a change to the security risk score of the selected delegate workspace.
13. The remote orchestrator of claim 1, wherein the program instructions, upon execution, further cause the remote orchestrator to select the delegate workspace, at least in part, based upon a productivity score associated with the delegate workspace.
14. The remote orchestrator of claim 13, wherein the program instructions, upon execution, further cause the remote orchestrator to identify additional or fewer management tasks to be assigned to the delegate workspace, at least in part, based upon a change to the productivity score.
15. The remote orchestrator of claim 13, wherein the program instructions, upon execution, further cause the remote orchestrator to re-assign the management task to another delegate workspace executed by another edge IHS, at least in part, based upon a change to the productivity score of the selected delegate workspace.
16. The remote orchestrator of claim 1, wherein the context information comprises at least one of: an identification of a location of the selected edge IHS, an identification of a user of the selected edge IHS, an identification of a network of the selected edge IHS, or an identification of hardware of the selected edge IHS.
17. A memory device having program instructions stored thereon that, upon execution by a processor of an edge Information Handling System (IHS), causes the edge IHS to: instantiate a delegate workspace; and process a management command received from a remote orchestrator, wherein the management command targets a workspace executed by a client IHS accessible to the edge IHS, and wherein the edge IHS is selected by the remote orchestrator, at least in part, based

upon at least one of: a productivity score of the workspace or a productivity score of the delegate workspace.

18. A method, comprising: receiving, at a client Information Handling System (IHS), a management command relayed by a delegate workspace instantiated by an edge IHS, wherein the management command is originated by a cloud orchestrator, and wherein the cloud orchestrator is configured to select the edge IHS among a plurality of edge IHS based, at least in part, upon at least one of: a productivity score of the workspace or a productivity score of the delegate workspace; and executing, by the client IHS, the management command.
